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Inventor(s)	Narayana; Usha et al.

Systems and methods for display notifications for routing of electronic transaction processing results

Abstract

A computer implemented system and method are disclosed involving technological advancements in the processing of electronic transaction processing results. The system may comprise a computer apparatus implementing a checking account system, a savings account system, a merchant account and investment account on a funds management system, and one or more computer systems and mobile devices including a communication interface, processor, memory storing computer-executable instructions, and savings modules. Reward amounts may be calculated based on various techniques.

Inventors: Narayana; Usha (Natick, MA), Summerrow; Kimberly Belle (Charlotte, NC)

Applicant: Bank of America Corporation (Charlotte, NC)

Family ID: 93464761

Assignee: Bank of America Corporation (Charlotte, NC)

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Primary Examiner: Masud; Rokib

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Banner & Witcoff, Ltd.

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of and claims priority to co-pending U.S. application Ser. No. 17/065,597, filed Oct. 8, 2020, and entitled, “Systems and Methods for Display Notifications For Routing of Electronic Transaction Processing Results,” which is a continuation of and claims priority to U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/222,495 (filed Dec. 17, 2018, as U.S. Pat. No. 10,810,674), which is a continuation of pending U.S. application Ser. No. 14/844,887 (filed Sep. 3, 2015, as U.S. Pat. No. 10,169,820), all of the aforementioned are herein incorporated by reference in their entireties. In addition, this application is a continuation of and claims priority to co-pending U.S. application Ser. No. 17/065,597, filed Oct. 8, 2020, and entitled, “Systems and Methods for Display Notifications For Routing of Electronic Transaction Processing Results,” which is a continuation-in-part of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/222,585 (filed on Dec. 17, 2018, as U.S. Pat. No. 10,817,860), which is a continuation of pending U.S. application Ser. No. 14/844,875 (filed Sep. 3, 2015, and granted Jan. 1, 2019, as U.S. Pat. No. 10,169,749), all of the aforementioned are herein incorporated by reference in their entireties.

RELATED APPLICATIONS

- (1) This application is related to U.S. application Ser. No. 11/161,418, filed Aug. 2, 2005, which is herein incorporated by reference in its entirety.
- (2) This application is related to PCT Application No. PCT/US07/61694, filed Feb. 6, 2007, which is herein incorporated by reference in its entirety.

- (3) This application is related to U.S. Application Ser. No. 61/027,397, filed Feb. 8, 2008, which is herein incorporated by reference in its entirety.
- (4) This application is related to U.S. application Ser. No. 12/368,034, filed Feb. 9, 2009, which is herein incorporated by reference in its entirety.
- (5) This application is related to U.S. application Ser. No. 12/554,616, filed Sep. 4, 2009, which is herein incorporated by reference in its entirety.
- (6) This application is related to U.S. application Ser. No. 12/730,394, filed Mar. 24, 2010, which is herein incorporated by reference in its entirety.
- (7) This application is related to U.S. application Ser. No. 14/109,269, filed Dec. 17, 2013, which is herein incorporated by reference in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(8) Aspects of the disclosure generally relate to technological improvements to automated and semi-automated fund transfers, notification systems and bonus payments associated with one or more accounts.

BACKGROUND

(9) Consumers sometimes feel that saving money is difficult. Those who earn less or are supporting a family may find it particularly challenging to put money away for emergencies, a child's education, or a special purchase. Even affluent consumers sometimes feel that they should save more money.

(10) A consumer can save funds in a bank account by making deposits into the account or by transferring funds from another account. In addition, grandparents or other relatives or friends sometimes desire to contribute money to somebody else's (e.g., a grandchild's) savings account.

(11) There remains room for technological improvements in systems and methods for automatically facilitating and/or encouraging savings.

BRIEF SUMMARY

(12) The following presents a simplified summary of the disclosure in order to provide a basic understanding of some aspects. It is not intended to identify key or critical elements of the invention or to delineate the scope of the invention. The following summary merely presents some concepts of the disclosure in a simplified form as a prelude to the more detailed description provided below.

(13) A computer implemented system and method are disclosed of processing a financial transaction that includes determining an automatic savings amount and rewards amount payments. The system may comprises a checking account, a savings account, an account of a merchant, and one or more computer systems including a communication interface, processor, and memory storing computer-executable instructions. The rewards amount may be calculated based on various techniques.

(14) Aspects of the disclosure generally relate to automated funds transfer and bonus payments associated with an account.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The present disclosure is illustrated by way of example and not limited in the accompanying figures in which like reference numerals indicate similar elements and in which:

(2) FIG. 1 shows an illustrative operating environment in which various aspects of the disclosure may be implemented; and

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates a flowchart depicting various steps performed in accordance with aspects of the disclosure.

(4) FIG. 3 illustrates a flowchart depicting a method in accordance with aspects of the disclosure.

- (5) FIG. 4 shows an illustrative operating environment in which various aspects of the disclosure may be implemented.
- (6) FIG. 5 shows an illustrative operating environment in which various aspects of the disclosure may be implemented.
- (7) FIG. 6 illustrates a flowchart depicting an enrollment method in accordance with aspects of the disclosure.
- (8) FIG. 6B illustrates a flowchart depicting an additional enrollment method in accordance with aspects of the disclosure.
- (9) FIG. 7 illustrates a flowchart depicting a method of accumulated savings for selective distribution in accordance with aspects of the disclosure.
- (10) FIG. 8 illustrates a flowchart depicting a method of additional savings notifications in accordance with aspects of the disclosure.
- (11) FIG. 9 illustrates a flowchart depicting a method of a savings goal indicator in accordance with aspects of the disclosure.
- (12) FIG. 10 illustrates a flowchart depicting a method of merchant or product based savings in accordance with aspects of the disclosure.
- (13) FIG. 11 illustrates a flowchart depicting a method of frictionless savings in accordance with aspects of the disclosure.
- (14) FIG. 12 illustrates a flowchart depicting a method of discount savings in accordance with aspects of the disclosure.
- (15) FIG. 13 illustrates a flowchart depicting a posting method in accordance with aspects of the disclosure.
- (16) FIG. 14 illustrates a flowchart depicting a method of matching savings in accordance with aspects of the disclosure.
- (17) FIG. 15 depicts a graphic user interface depicting a method of enrollment in accordance with aspects of the disclosure.
- (18) FIG. 16 depicts a graphic user interface depicting a further method of enrollment in accordance with aspects of the disclosure.
- (19) FIG. 17 depicts an example savings message type packet in accordance with aspects of the disclosure.
- (20) FIG. 18 depicts a graphic user interface depicting a further method of enrollment in an investment savings program in accordance with aspects of the disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (21) In accordance with various aspects of the disclosure, a method and system for enhanced automatic savings is disclosed. In one embodiment, computer implemented systems and methods are disclosed for processing a financial transaction that may include determining an automatic savings amount, providing notifications of savings updates, and providing payments as a reward for savings. The system includes computing systems that operate to process transactions associated with various types of accounts. Examples of such accounts may include a checking account, a savings account, a merchant account, and investment account, and one or more computer systems and mobile devices including a communication interface, processor, memory storing computer-executable instructions, and savings modules. The system further includes computing systems that operate to determine reward amounts based on automatic savings. The rewards amount may be calculated based on various techniques.
- (22) In one embodiment, a computer implemented savings program automatically generates a savings amount from each financial transaction by a user of a bank or other financial institution and deposits the savings amount in the user's or somebody else's savings account; thus the user can accumulate savings conveniently and painlessly. In addition, automated loan payments, and automated contributions to charitable and charitable-like (e.g., environmental funds) organizations may be made in a similar fashion.

(23) In another embodiment, a computer implemented savings program automatically generates a savings amount from each financial transaction by a user of a bank or other financial institution, determines when a level of savings is reached, notifies a user of the savings amount, and provides an interface presenting input elements for the user to select where the savings amount should be deposited.

(24) In one embodiment, a computer implemented savings program automatically generates a savings amount from each financial transaction by a user of a bank or other financial institution. In addition, the savings program monitors the user's saving progress and may present the user with an option to add additional savings which are deposited in the user's or somebody else's savings account.

(25) In another embodiment, a computer implemented savings program automatically generates a savings amount from each financial transaction by a user of a bank or other financial institution and notifies a user as to the user's progress towards a saving goal once a level of savings is reached or a certain time period has elapsed.

(26) In another embodiment, a computer implemented savings program automatically generates a savings amount from each financial transaction by a user of a bank or other financial institution based on comparable transaction amounts for matched products or merchants.

(27) In another embodiment, a computer implemented savings program automatically generates a savings amount from each financial transaction by a user of a bank or other financial institution based on discounts provided by merchants.

(28) In one embodiment, a computer implemented savings program automatically generates a savings amount from each financial transaction by a user of a bank or other financial institution. In addition, the savings program monitors the user's saving progress and adjusts the automatic saving methods to keep the user on track to reach their savings goal.

(29) FIG. 1 illustrates an example of a suitable computing system environment **100** that may be used according to one or more illustrative embodiments of the disclosure. The computing system environment **100** is only one example of a suitable computing environment and is not intended to suggest any limitation as to the scope of use or functionality of the disclosure. The computing system environment **100** should not be interpreted as having any dependency or requirement relating to any one or combination of components illustrated in the exemplary computing system environment **100**.

(30) The disclosure is operational with numerous computing system environments or configurations. Examples of computing systems, environments, and/or configurations that may be suitable for use with the disclosure include, but are not limited to, personal computers, server computers, hand-held or laptop devices, multiprocessor systems, microprocessor-based systems, set top boxes, programmable consumer electronics, network PCs, minicomputers, mainframe computers, distributed computing environments that include any of the above systems or devices, and the like that have been programmed with particular instructions to carry out one or more of the functional aspects described in further detail below either individually or in conjunction with one another.

(31) The disclosure may be described in the general context of computer-executable instructions, such as program modules, being executed by a computer. Generally, program modules include routines, programs, objects, components, data structures, and the like that perform particular tasks or implement particular abstract data types. The disclosure may also be practiced in distributed computing environments where tasks are performed by remote processing devices that are linked through a communications network. In a distributed computing environment, program modules may be located in both local and remote computer storage media including memory storage devices.

(32) With reference to FIGS. 1 and 4, computer implemented systems for processing enhanced automatic savings are shown. The computing system environment **100** may include a computing

device **101** having a processor **103** for controlling overall operation of the computing device **101** and its associated components, including RAM **105**, ROM **107**, communications module **109**, and memory **115**. Computing device **101** typically includes a variety of computer readable media. Computer readable media may be any available media that may be accessed by computing device **101** and include both volatile and nonvolatile media, removable and non-removable media. By way of example, and not limitation, computer readable media may comprise computer storage media and communication media. Computer storage media includes volatile and nonvolatile, removable and non-removable media implemented in any method or technology for storage of information such as computer readable instructions, data structures, program modules or other data. Computer storage media includes, but is not limited to, random access memory (RAM), read only memory (ROM), electronically erasable programmable read only memory (EEPROM), flash memory or other memory technology, CD-ROM, digital versatile disks (DVD) or other optical disk storage, magnetic cassettes, magnetic tape, magnetic disk storage or other magnetic storage devices, or any other medium that can be used to store the desired information and that can be accessed by computing device **101**. Communication media typically embodies computer readable instructions, data structures, program modules or other data in a modulated data signal such as a carrier wave or other transport mechanism and includes any information delivery media. Modulated data signal is a signal that has one or more of its characteristics set or changed in such a manner as to encode information in the signal. By way of example, and not limitation, communication media includes wired media such as a wired network or direct-wired connection, and wireless media such as acoustic, RF, infrared and other wireless media. Combinations of any of the above should also be included within the scope of computer readable media. Although not shown, RAM **105** may include one or more applications representing the application data stored in RAM memory **105** while the computing device is on and corresponding software applications (e.g., software tasks), are running on the computing device **101**.

(33) With reference to FIGS. **1** and **4**, communications module **109** may include a microphone, keypad, touch screen, and/or stylus through which a user of computing device **101** may provide input, and may also include one or more of a speaker for providing audio output and a video display device for providing textual, audiovisual and/or graphical output. Software may be stored within memory **115** and/or storage to provide instructions to processor **103** for enabling computing device **101** to perform various functions. For example, memory **115** may store software used by the computing device **101**, such as an operating system **117**, application programs **119**, and an associated database **121**. Alternatively, some or all of the computer executable instructions for computing device **101** may be embodied in hardware or firmware (not shown). As described in detail below, the database **121** may provide centralized storage of account information and account holder information for the entire business, allowing interoperability between different elements of the business residing at different physical locations.

(34) With reference to FIGS. **1**, **4**, and **5**, computing device **101** may operate in a networked environment supporting connections to one or more remote computing devices, such as branch terminals **141** and **151**, point of sale (POS) device **162**, ATM **163**, retail locations **164**, **165**, and **166**, personal computer **161**, smartphone **171**, tablet **181**, and smartwatch **191**. The branch computing devices **141** and **151** may be personal computing devices or servers that include many or all of the elements described above relative to the computing device **101**. Moreover, as with POS **162**, branch terminals **141** and **151**, smartphone **171**, or tablet **181** may be POS devices coupled to a computer server (e.g., a computer system operated by a bank or other financial institution) via a network (e.g., one or more routers or computer systems, a computer system operated by the issuer of the credit card or debit card/check card used to make a purchase, and the like) for receiving financial account information (e.g., a credit card reader, debit card reader, check scanner, online bill pay interface, and the like). The POS devices listed above may be electronic cash registers that include barcode reader **192** that is used to read barcodes on products and to automatically enter the

products and prices into POS. POS devices may further include a card reader **111** that reads account information from a credit card, debit card, or any other type of financial device that can be used to purchase an item. POS devices may include other devices, such as a keypad, that can also be used to read account information for facilitating a transaction. In one embodiment, POS devices may be located at a retailer.

(35) The network connections depicted in FIGS. **1** and **4** include a local area network (LAN) **125** and a wide area network (WAN) **129**, but may also include other networks. When used in a LAN networking environment, computing device **101** is connected to the LAN **125** through a network interface or adapter in the communications module **109**. When used in a WAN networking environment, the server **101** may include a modem in the communications module **109** or other means for establishing communications over the WAN **129**, such as the Internet **131**. It will be appreciated that the network connections shown are illustrative and other means of establishing a communications link between the computing devices may be used. Communications module **109** may further include a near field communications device (NFC), infrared, or short range wireless devices, such as Bluetooth. The existence of any of various well-known protocols such as TCP/IP, Ethernet, FTP, HTTP and the like is presumed, and the system can be operated in a client-server configuration to permit a user to retrieve web pages from a web-based server. Any of various conventional web browsers can be used to display and manipulate data on web pages.

(36) Additionally, an application program **119** used by the computing device **101** according to an illustrative embodiment of the disclosure may include computer executable instructions for invoking user functionality related to communication, such as email, short message service (SMS), and voice input and speech recognition applications.

(37) In reference to FIG. **5**, computer system **101** may include additional savings module **843A**, savings goal module **944A**, merchant product module **1045A**, frictionless savings module **1146A**, discount savings module **1238A**, or selective distribution module **1242A**. These modules may carry out savings programs as described in aspects of the present disclosure for helping users achieve their savings goals. Additionally, personal computer **161**, smartphone **171**, tablet **181**, smartwatch **191**, computer system **151** and computer system **141** may also have additional savings module **843B**, savings goal module **944B**, merchant product module **1045B**, frictionless savings module **1146B**, discount savings module **1238B**, or selective distribution module **1242B** as shown at personal computer **161**, but which have been omitted from smartphone **171**, tablet **181**, smartwatch **191**, computer system **151** and computer system **141** in FIG. **5** for the sake of clarity.

(38) In accordance with aspects of the disclosure, a method is contemplated to enhance the ability to save money. In one embodiment, the method permits a debit card holder to save as that individual makes everyday purchases. For example, when the debit card holder uses the debit card to make a purchase, the transaction amount for each purchase may be increased to the next integer dollar amount if the transaction is not already an integer dollar amount. If the transaction amount is already an integer value, under alternative embodiments in accordance with aspects of the disclosure, the transaction amount may still be increased to the next greater integer value, or alternatively, remain unchanged. The difference between the actual amount and the increased amount is transferred from the holder's checking account to another account (e.g., a savings account); thus, creating an interest-paying virtual change jar. The aforementioned approach of increasing the transaction amount may be referenced in this disclosure as “the increasing approach.” One skilled in the art will appreciate after review of the present disclosure that other triggering events/acts and other techniques for determining a savings amount to transfer are contemplated.

(39) Continuing with the above example, the account holder can receive an additional bonus or match money to encourage use of the savings program. For example, the bonus or match money may be in the form of interest that would be in addition to the interest the holder would normally earn in an interest-bearing account. For example, at the end of the year, the holder's financial

institution may match the transferred savings at 100% for the first 3 months and 5% thereafter. The holder may continue to receive this 5% match reward of the transferred savings each year around the anniversary date. This bonus or match money may be capped, for example, up to a predetermined amount of money (e.g., \$250). One skilled in the art will appreciate after review of the entirety disclosed herein that the disclosure contemplates other techniques for matching or providing a bonus. For example, one of numerous variations contemplated by the disclosure includes providing different percentage/amount of interest yield during a particular time period. (40) Disclosed herein are various techniques that may be implemented in an automated savings program as well as various aspects of such an automated savings program. First, the process for user eligibility for matching and enrollment is disclosed. Second, various aspects of savings are disclosed (e.g., calculating the amount, when the amount is transferred, saving for other purposes, credit card transactions, and the like). Third, techniques are disclosed to protect against potentially exceeding the account balance. Finally, various techniques are disclosed for providing a match or bonus. Those skilled in the art will appreciate that any combination of these techniques and aspects may be implemented.

(41) A financial institution may offer the aforementioned financial product/method to new account holders or prospective account holders. In one aspect of the eligibility/enrollment process, based upon user segmentation (e.g., user account status—regular, premium, platinum, gold, and the like; debt card usage—low, moderate, high; and the like), the financial institution may offer varying aspects and/or levels (e.g., higher matching levels, minimum balance requirements, and the like) of financial product/methods to account holders. In another aspect of the eligibility/enrollment process, an account holder may be able to discontinue (i.e., dis-enroll) from the savings program through online and/or other (e.g., telephone, in-person, and the like) methods. Moreover, the account holder may dis-enroll temporarily, for example, to avoid exceeding the account balance. In some instances, a financial institution may configure the automated savings amount transfers such that if the source account balance is below a predefined threshold (e.g., \$10) amount, then the automatic savings amount transfers are temporarily deactivated. As such, during the temporary deactivation, the account holder would not enjoy the benefit of automated savings and matching/bonus. Additional features related to exceeding the account balance are also discussed later in this disclosure. In one example, the temporary deactivation feature may be configurable by the account holder through an online interface (e.g., the financial institution's website).

(42) Referring now to FIG. 6, a flow diagram of the functionality performed by computer system **101** in accordance with one embodiment of the present disclosure in order to enroll a user in the automatic savings program is shown. The disclosures below will reference elements depicted in FIGS. 1 and 4.

(43) In step **600**, a customer of a financial institution requests enrollment in an automatic savings program.

(44) In step **602**, account set-up and maintenance screens/interfaces are accessed in response to a user request to enroll in the automatic savings program. In one embodiment, the screens/interfaces are accessed by bank personnel at a terminal locally or remotely connected to computer system **101**. In another embodiment, a user may access the screens/interfaces at a terminal remotely connected to computer system **101** through Internet **131**. In another embodiment, the user may access the screens/interfaces with any wireless device capable of connecting to computer system **101** through Internet **131**, such as ATM **163**, personal computer **161**, tablet **181**, smartphone **171**, or smartwatch **191**.

(45) In step **604**, the checking account that is the source of the automatic savings amount is selected. The eligible source accounts are displayed from the user's profile (step **605**). In other embodiments, another type of account instead of a checking account can be used, as long as the selected account is a source of funds.

(46) In step **606**, the types of debits/transactions that are to be “round up” are selected. “Round up”

refers to one method used to calculate a savings amount from a transaction. In one embodiment, the round up amount is an amount of excess funds produced by applying a rounder transaction to the amount of a transaction such as a credit/debit card charge at POS **162**. If the rounder transaction rounds up to the nearest dollar, for example, a purchase made for \$54.08 would generate a rounded amount of \$0.92. Other embodiments of the present disclosure may round up to a predetermined amount besides the nearest dollar. Still further, other embodiments of the present disclosure may calculate the savings amount using a method other than round up. For example, a fixed percentage can be applied to each transaction to calculate a savings amount, or a fixed amount of money (e.g., \$1.20) can be considered the savings amount. The available debits/transaction types to be round up are displayed (step **607**) and can include check card/debit card POS transactions, or any other types of debits. Examples of other debits that can be the subject of round up or other calculation of a savings amount include paper checks, electronic bill pay, electronic checks, automatic payments and Automated Clearing House (“ACH”) transfers.

(47) In step **608**, the recipient account or accounts for the savings amount may be selected based on the displayed eligible recipient accounts (step **611**) and preference option fields for the accounts can be inputted. In one embodiment, possible recipient accounts include the user's own recipient account, person-to-person transfer (e.g., a grandparent's round ups being credited to a grandchild's recipient account), and the like. In general, any recipient account that can accept transfers can be eligible for selection. If multiple recipient accounts are selected, the user can choose a percentage distribution for each of the recipient accounts, or another mechanism that can be used to divide the savings amount between the multiple accounts or create a preference for savings between the accounts.

(48) In step **610**, goals may be selected for the recipient account or accounts. In one embodiment, the computer system may present the user with an option to input the user's desired financial goals (step **609**). To determine the user's desired financial goals, the server may request information from the user regarding the user's qualitative or quantitative goals, such as “buy a car,” “pay for child's college education” or “save \$2,000.” The computer system can additionally request a time frame to achieve this goal, and may also request the user's income and expenditures, and any additional information that may be relevant to ascertaining the appropriate savings method for the user. A separate goal can be selected for each recipient account if multiple recipient accounts are selected for the program. The user may also select intermediate goals for a recipient account to help the user stay on track for reaching their goal for the recipient account.

(49) In step **612**, notification services may be selected for the savings accounts. The computer system may display the notification options (step **613**).

(50) In step **614**, the user disclosures may be presented to the user to agree to before enrollment as display notifications (step **613**).

(51) Referring to FIG. **15**, a graphical user interface (GUI) of an embodiment of the present disclosure showing an enrollment interface for a user to enroll in a savings program is shown. In the example disclosed in FIG. **15**, a user may enroll in a savings program via a GUI interface. In reference to FIG. **5**, a GUI interface may be accessed via branch terminals **141** and **151**, ATM **163**, retail locations **164**, **165**, and **166**, personal computer **161**, smartphone **171**, tablet **181**, and smartwatch **191**.

(52) In step **1500**, the user selects the source checking account via the GUI interface.

(53) In step **1502**, the user selects the recipient savings account(s).

(54) In step **1504**, the user enters the savings goals for the recipient account(s).

(55) In step **1506**, the user selects the savings methods for the recipient account(s). The user may select one, or multiple savings methods as shown (step **1512**). The enrollment program may also give projected time frames for completing the user's savings goals (step **1514**) based on a time frame and savings amount disclosed by the user (step **1504**). Further, the enrollment GUI may also recommend particular savings methods based on the goals entered by the user (**1516**).

(56) In step **1508**, the user selects notifications for the savings methods, as described more fully in reference to FIGS. **7-10**, and **12**.

(57) In step **1510**, the user is presented with terms and conditions and to finalize the enrollment process.

(58) In one embodiment, the savings amount may be transferred from a first source account (e.g., any type of account as long as it is a source of funds) to a recipient account (e.g., a money market account, a savings account, and the like). In an alternative embodiment, the savings amount may be transferred from a first source account to multiple recipient accounts. Such an alternative embodiment provides additional flexibility of the savings program for the user.

(59) In yet another embodiment, the savings amount may be applied against outstanding debt. For example, the savings amount may be used to pay down debt (e.g., mortgage, student loans, credit cards, and the like) as another use of the money saved. Any matching (or bonus) amount may also be applied against outstanding debt. In another embodiment, the recipient account may be a retirement account (e.g., an IRA account, Roth IRA account, and the like).

(60) In accordance with various aspects of the disclosure, the savings amount automatically transferred from an account holder's source account to a recipient account may be calculated based on one or more factors. For example, under an increasing approach a transaction amount may be increased to the next highest integer value. Meanwhile, under another approach, the transferred savings amount may be calculated by decreasing the transaction amount to the previous lowest integer value if the transaction is not already an integer dollar amount. If the transaction amount is already an integer value, under alternative embodiments in accordance with aspects of the disclosure, the transaction amount may still be decreased to the previous lowest integer value, or alternatively, remain unchanged. The aforementioned approach of decreasing the transaction amount may be referenced in this disclosure as "the decreasing approach."

(61) As further explained below, the decreasing approach may be useful in the case of a savings program based on credit card transactions. In another example, the savings amount may be a fixed amount (e.g., \$1, \$0.50, \$5, and the like) per transaction. In yet another example, the total savings amount for a period of time (e.g., a year) may be limited to a predefined maximum amount.

(62) In an alternative embodiment, an account holder may customize (e.g., through an online graphical user interface) the specifics of its automated savings program. For example, the user may configure, at account enrollment and thereafter, one or more various features of the automated savings account discussed herein including, but not limited to, the following: the source account(s), the recipient account(s), the savings scheme (round-up, percentage amount, predetermined dollar amount, and the like), the aggressiveness of the savings scheme (e.g., in the case of an increasing approach, the amount of transferred savings), charitable savings, payment of exiting loans, or savings for a specified purchase item. For example, a user may designate the increasing approach to use the next highest \$5 denomination. As such, the amount of transferred savings amount is greater. Likewise, the aggressiveness of the transferred savings amount may be controlled for other types of savings amounts disclosed herein and contemplated by one of skill in the art after review of the entirety disclosed herein. Such an embodiment provides customization of the savings program for the user account. Such a computer system may send information about user preferences/settings are used by an incentive engine and/or provided to a parameter-based rules engine (e.g., an incentive engine that accepts different parameters to customize the matching/savings aspects for a user in accordance with various aspects of the disclosure.).

(63) Each of the above-referenced customizable features may be implemented as a parameter for the user's accounts. In one example, once the user's account has configured for the customized automated savings program, values for the various parameters may be passed to the deposit applications. This information may be passed to deposit applications, in one example, as part of eligibility information. The deposit applications may thereby implement the user's customized savings program in accordance with the parameter values provided. The deposit applications may

determine the transferred savings amount based on the parameter designated for the increasing approach (\$5 denominations, \$10 denominations, and the like). These transferred savings amounts may be aggregated together for each account, and one debit may be charged to the checking account. Referring to FIG. 2, if sufficient funds were available, the transaction may post to the checking account (in step **206**) and a request for transfer to the recipient account is sent to a credit engine. The credit engine verifies the existence and status of the receiving account and creates a credit transaction for the transferred savings amount to post in the next processing cycle. It will be appreciated that the amount of customization that is afforded to the user is proportional to the complexity of the system for the financial institution.

(64) In accordance with aspects of the disclosure, the transfer of the savings amount from a source account to a recipient account may occur at various times and/or time intervals. For example, as described in one embodiment in U.S. application Ser. No. 11/161,418 filed Aug. 2, 2005, which was previously incorporated by reference herein, the savings amounts for all transaction in a day may be aggregated and a single transfer may be performed daily. One skilled in the art will appreciate after review of the present disclosure that the transfer operation may occur at various times (e.g., weekly, monthly, bi-weekly, bi-daily, annually, and the like). For example, the savings amount may be transferred in near real-time (i.e., a separate transaction for transferring the savings amount for each transaction may be processed once the triggering transaction has been received at computer system **101**.) As such, an account holder may find numerous transfers of savings amounts occurring throughout a day instead of a single aggregated transfer.

(65) Referring to FIG. 13, a flow diagram of the functionality performed by computer system **101** in accordance with one embodiment of the present invention to perform a daily posting of the automatic investment transaction is shown.

(66) In step **300**, the aggregated round up debit transaction is posted.

(67) In step **302**, the credit transaction is created.

(68) In step **304**, a determination is made if the recipient account(s) selected at step **608** of FIG. 6 is valid. If it is valid, the credit transaction is posted (step **310**).

(69) In step **306**, if the recipient account(s) is not valid at step **304**, the credit transaction is returned to the source account and a \$0.00 transaction is created with a status descriptor. A report of the invalid source account is sent to an “exceptions & returns” file and enrollment of the automatic investment account for that customer is terminated (steps **312**, **314**).

(70) In step **316**, monthly statements are generated that include the automatic investment function. Both the source and recipient accounts may display a month-to-date and year-to-date summary of round up transfers on their statements.

(71) In another embodiment of the present disclosure, as eligible transactions are received at the financial institution, they may be posted to the deposit account in a near real-time process. Various techniques may be used to calculate the transferred savings amount using the increasing approach. In one such technique, each transaction received by the deposit account may have its transferred savings amount under the increasing approach calculated and posted at the time of the transaction. The aforementioned transaction may be sent immediately to a credit engine. The credit engine may create a transaction which may be sent immediately to a receiving account. Under another technique, each transaction received by the deposit account would have the transferred savings amount using an increasing approach calculated and stored in a bucket. During the end of day reconciliation, the stored value may be compared to the ending balance, and if the balance remains positive, a transaction may be posted to the deposit account. This amount will be sent to a credit engine to perform the same process as in the aforementioned technique.

(72) In accordance with aspects of the disclosure, the savings amount may be obtained automatically from one or more source accounts. For example, an account holder may designate a checking account at a financial institution as the source account. In another embodiment, the account holder may designate more than one source account, for example, an alternate source

account in the event that an account contains inadequate funds. Alternatively, the savings amount may be sourced from multiple accounts and the percentage to be taken from each account may be designated (e.g., 25% from checking account A and 75% from checking account B). Such an embodiment provides additional flexibility of the savings program for the user.

(73) In accordance with various embodiments of the disclosure, the savings amount may be transferred to a recipient account. The recipient account (e.g., savings account) may be a high interest yield account designated for such a savings program. In some embodiments, the recipient account may be configured such that the account holder may not be able to withdraw the transferred savings amount from the recipient account before a predefined period of time (e.g., one year) without incurring additional charges. As such, the savings account encourages the account holder to save money and earn a higher interest yield.

(74) In an alternative embodiment, the savings amount may be transferred from a first source account to multiple recipient accounts (e.g., a money market account, a savings account, retirement account, and the like). In yet another alternative embodiment, the multiple recipient accounts may be owned by different people. Such an embodiment provides additional flexibility of the savings program for the user. U.S. application Ser. No. 11/161,418 filed Aug. 2, 2005, which was previously incorporated by reference herein, lists numerous examples of recipient account configurations.

(75) In another embodiment, the savings amount may be applied against outstanding debt. For example, the savings amount may be used to pay down debt as another use of the money saved. Any matching (or bonus) amount may also be configured to be applied against outstanding debt. For example, instead of creating a deposit to the savings account, a credit generating system in communication with computer system **101** may create a payment to, for example, an associated credit card, a personal or business loan, a home mortgage or home equity loan, a car loan, a student loan, and the like. Moreover, business rules may be formulated and used to determine whether the payment is applied to interest or principle. In an embodiment where the savings amount is applied to a non-credit card debt, a similar technical implementation may be taken. For example, computer system **101** may submit a payment on behalf of the account holder to reduce the outstanding debt. Similar to the technical steps to create a transaction to pay down credit card debt as explained herein, the automated payment of a student loan debt, car loan debt, and other debt vehicles perform accordingly. Rather, the transaction for each type of debt vehicle may require formatting according to the receiving system.

(76) In yet another embodiment, the recipient account may be a retirement account (e.g., an IRA account, Roth IRA account, 401(k) account, and the like). Alternatively, the recipient account may be a gift card account where the account holder's savings are applied to a gift that he/she may use themselves or give to another as a gift. Alternatively, the recipient account may be a health savings account.

(77) In yet another example, an automated savings program may allow an account holder to participate in a charitable program. In the example provided with reference to FIG. 3, a user may enroll in a charitable program (step **1002**) that draws additional funds through additional charges to debit purchases (step **1006**), that is used to purchase an environmental initiative program (step **1014**). By enrolling and participate in this environmental program, a financial institution adds a predetermined amount (e.g., \$0.01) to the account holder's total purchase amount for each transaction (e.g., each time they use their debit card) (step **1006**). One skilled in the art will appreciate that the financial institution has the option of offering differing amounts (e.g., amount higher (or lower) than 1¢ per transaction) to its account holder; thereby creating more (or less) purchasing power to the environmental program. Such an embodiment provides additional flexibility of the savings program for the user.

(78) Next, in participating in a charitable program, the account holder may make a purchase using a debit card (step **1004**). This transaction is sent through a point of sale (POS) device, such as those

described in U.S. application Ser. No. 11/161,418 filed Aug. 2, 2005, which was previously incorporated by reference herein, and the account holder may be charged the additional predetermined amount (step **1006**). One skilled in the art will appreciate that this fixed amount could be withdrawn from not only debit card transactions, but also credit card transactions, or other purchases completed by an equivalent account and/or card. When the predetermined amount is withdrawn from the user and transferred to the environment program, the transfer transaction is received and recorded by a computer system at the financial institution (step **1008**). In one example in accordance with aspects of the disclosure, the predetermined amount may be routed to a separate, second environment fund (step **1010**). The predetermined amounts from each of the users enrolled in the program may be pooled together (step **1012**). Following this, the pooled funds can be paid to the environmental program (step **1014**).

(79) Another example, similar to the one described above, begins with an account holder selecting to contribute to an environmental program which purchases carbon offsets. This type of environmental program may give the account holder a simple way to partially neutralize their carbon impact and be part of a larger collective initiative. The account holder may configure their participation in the program to add one cent (1¢) to each of his/her debit card transactions. The account holder may then make a purchase of \$1.50 using their debit card. The account holder may be charged an additional 1¢ for a total of \$1.51. The 1¢ may be routed to a separate account which will be used to purchase carbon offsets and may be centrally pooled together with other account holders participating in the environmental program. Finally, with these pooled funds, carbon offsets may then be purchased. With a program such as this, the account holders of a financial institution may be collectively responsible for: negating the impact of 150,000 SUVs on the road for a year, or protecting the equivalent of 4,800 football fields of tropical rainforest from deforestation, or negating the impact of 1,000 residents of each of the 50 states for a year.

(80) In addition to the use of a debit card as disclosed in U.S. application Ser. No. 11/161,418 filed Aug. 2, 2005, which was previously incorporated by reference, other events/acts may result in an automatic transfer occurring. For example, the use of a credit card in making a purchase may act as a trigger to cause the transfer of a savings amount for the credit card holder. When the holder makes a purchase using a credit card associated with a financial institution, the purchase transaction amount is decreased using a decreasing approach, actually reducing the amount the holder is charged. In some embodiments, the transaction amount may be reduced by less than the aforementioned amount. In one example, the savings amount may be a fixed amount or a percentage of the savings amount.

(81) In addition, the financial institution may transfer the difference between the amount of the transaction under a decreasing approach and the actual transaction amount from the holder's checking account to a second account. For example, User #1 uses a credit card to make a purchase for \$10.25. The transaction amount charged to User #1 for the purchase is decreased to \$10. Moreover, the financial institution covers the outstanding \$0.25 on User #1's behalf as a bonus/matching amount. Furthermore, the bank transfers \$0.25 (i.e., the bonus/matching amount) from User #1 checking account at the financial institution to her savings account. As such, the financial institution facilitates a savings program for the account holder. In some embodiments, at the end of the year (or any other period of time), the financial institution may yet again reward the card holder by matching a percentage (e.g., 100%, 50%, and the like) of the transferred savings amounts. Alternatively, the card holder may be rewarded in many of the other ways as described throughout this disclosure. The card holder may choose to have this matched/bonus amount applied against any credit card balance, or may be deposited into any of the holder's accounts (e.g., checking, savings, and the like).

(82) In another embodiment in accordance with aspects of the disclosure, when an account holder makes a purchase using a credit card associated with a financial institution, the difference between the transaction amount and the increased amount under an increasing approach is transferred from

the holder's checking account to another account (e.g., a savings account). For example, User #2 uses a credit card to make a purchase for \$10.25.

(83) The transaction amount for the purchase remains \$10.25. Meanwhile, the financial institution deposits \$0.75 to a savings account under User #2's name as a bonus amount. As such, the financial institution facilitates a savings program for the account holder.

(84) Furthermore, as described in U.S. application Ser. No. 11/161,418 filed Aug. 2, 2005, which was previously incorporated by reference, a method contemplated to enhance a person's ability to save money may include a feature to protect and/or avoid exceeding the account balance. Such a feature designed to avoid exceeding the account balance may include, in some embodiments, a retroactive feature. In one example such a feature enables a financial institution to postpone the transfer of a savings amount if the transfer would result in the holder's source account exceeding its account balance. The financial institution may retry the postponed transfer at a later time (e.g., after six hours has elapsed, after twelve hours has elapsed, and the like) and/or at regular intervals (e.g., daily, bi-daily, hourly, weekly, and the like). For example, the financial institution may predefine the maximum number of retries (e.g., five retries) and the interval between each retry (e.g., wait one day between each retry) to prevent a scenario where postponed transfers are accrued and retried indefinitely. In yet another example, a portion of the savings amount may be applied without causing a negative account balance, while the remaining portion is postponed (or cancelled) as described in the aforementioned retroactive feature.

(85) Alternatively, a feature designed to avoid exceeding the account balance, in accordance with aspects of the disclosure, may include an option to designate a second source account to be used if a transfer of the savings amount from the first source account would cause it to exceed the account balance. The second source account may be of any type recognized by one of skill in the art as a viable source of funds. Examples of such sources of funds are disclosed or suggested throughout this disclosure.

(86) In yet another embodiment in accordance with aspects of the disclosure, a feature designed to avoid exceeding the account balance may include a grace period during which an account holder may remedy the situation of exceeding the account balance to avoid charges associated with exceeding the account balance. For example, an account holder may deposit funds in an account before the close of the business day to eliminate any occurrences of exceeding the account balance that may have been caused earlier in the day due to transactions. In such a situation, the account holder may not be charged for exceeding the account balance (or may be charged only a reduced amount or percentage of the normal fee for exceeding the account balance).

(87) In accordance with aspects of the disclosure, a computer system may be used as a base to implement one or more aspects of the feature designed to avoid exceeding the account balance. Accounts that have a negative account balance may have the daily (or other time interval) transaction corresponding to the transfer savings amount added to a retry file with a counter for the number of days (or other time interval) the transaction can be reapplied. The computer system **101** may allow the financial institution to save these files and check the accounts for available funds for a period of time. The transactions from the retry file may be included with the next processing day's posting items. If the account has a negative account balance, the retry counter may be decremented by one and the transaction may be re-added to the retry file. If the account does not have a negative account balance, the aforementioned transactions may be passed forward for processing to create the savings credit. The computer system **101** may input the savings credit into a deposit system for a processing cycle.

(88) Referring to FIG. **14**, a flow diagram of the functionality performed by a computing system **101** in accordance with one embodiment of the present disclosure to implement a matching process in conjunction with the savings program is shown.

(89) In step **400**, during the daily posting process of FIG. **14**, or at another point in the process (e.g., quarterly, annually, and the like), the customer data file for the automatic investment program

is pulled. The data file stores all transactions eligible for matching and other data, such as the length of enrollment for the user, which can be used to determine if the user has met the matching incentive criteria.

(90) In step **402**, the computing system determines if the user has met the matching incentive criteria. If not, the matching process is ended (**408**).

(91) In step **404**, if the user meets the matching incentive at step **402**, the matching funds credit transaction is calculated. The matching funds are then posted to the recipient account (**406**).

(92) Referring to FIG. 2, a system and method are disclosed for providing payments as a reward for savings. In one example, the matching (i.e., bonus) paid to the account holder (in step **214**) may be based on one or more factors. For example, as described in one embodiment in U.S. application Ser. No. 11/161,418 filed Aug. 2, 2005, which was previously incorporated by reference herein, the financial institution (in step **218**) may offer to match the transferred savings amount under the increasing approach (or savings amount under other approaches) by providing \$0.05 for every transaction. In another example, the financial institution (in step **218**) may offer \$1.00 (or any other predefined amount) for every transaction (e.g., debit card purchase, credit card purchase, and the like). The matching may be provided for only a predetermined period of time, for example, during the first six months of enrolling in the program/product. Furthermore, the matching may be based on a percentage of the transferred savings amount (e.g., 100%-dollar for dollar, or 50%-50 cents to the dollar, and the like). Computer system **101** may verify that an account holder is eligible (in steps **208**, **210**, and/or **212**) for matching/bonus before crediting the match amount to the account holder's recipient account.

(93) In yet another embodiment in accordance with aspects of the disclosure, the matching/bonus amount may be a predetermined amount provided at a regular interval. For example, a \$100 may be automatically transferred from an account holder's checking account to a savings account. The \$100 transferred savings amount may be entitled to the same (or more or less, as would be apparent to one skilled in the art after review of the present disclosure) of a match/bonus as other savings amounts transferred into the account. For example, under a segmented approach, transferred savings amounts from debit card (or credit card) use may be entitled to full matching, while transferred savings amount from an automatic monthly transfer may be entitled to half matching. In addition, the period of time during which the account holder may qualify for matching on the different types of transferred savings amounts may also vary (e.g., the automatic monthly transfers are eligible for matching for only three months, while the other type may be eligible for six months). In another embodiment, the matching may require that the total balance on the account is growing month after month. In yet another embodiment, the account holder may be required to maintain a minimum balance in an account (e.g., checking and/or savings) to be eligible for matching/bonus.

(94) In yet another embodiment, the total amount of matching/bonus for a given period of time (e.g., one year) may be limited to a predefined maximum value. Alternatively, the number of transactions eligible for matching during a given time period (e.g., a day) may be limited to a predefined maximum number.

(95) In reference to FIGS. 1 and 2, in another example, the match/bonus may be based (in step **208**) on a balance tier system (i.e., the amount of balance in a holder's account may categorize them into different tiers with varying matching/bonus levels). An incentive engine executing in a computer system **101** (e.g., using processor **103**) may receive the appropriate balance total from a deposit system. The received balance total may be a pre-calculated value that the computer system **101** may use without further intensive processing. Alternatively, the received balance total may be calculated at computer system **101** in numerous ways in accordance with aspects of the disclosure: a multi-month moving average, monthly average, current balance, average daily balance over the prior 12 months, average daily balance over the last 30 days, balance at the time the matching/bonus amount is calculated (i.e., the balance in the account on the date when the, e.g.,

debit card purchase occurred), minimum balance during the prior 30 days, average over the last 90 days, and the like. The incentive engine may comprise of computer-executable instructions used to determine the match level based on this calculated balance. The incentive engine may access (e.g., in memory **115**) a table with information about match level and the balance total corresponding to that match level. At least one technical benefit of such a system is that it allows the tiers or match levels to be changed with greater flexibility.

(96) For example, an account holder with a balance less than \$1,000 may receive a 2% match on the transferred savings amount. Meanwhile, an account holder with a balance of at least \$1,000, but not more than \$10,000 may receive a higher match (e.g., 5%) on the savings amount. Moreover, a holder with a balance of \$10,000 or more may receive an even higher percentage match. One skilled in the art after review of the present disclosure will appreciate that the matching may be other than a percentage amount. For example, the balance tier may include an approach where, as the balance increases, the matching is a predetermined amount per transaction that also increases with each balance tier.

(97) In another example, the match (or bonus) may be comprised of rewards based on certain user purchase behavior (e.g., double the match for gas purchases). Yet another way to reward users may be based on the number of transactions or purchase volume over certain period of time. For example, an institution may provide a higher matching level to an account holder that achieves more than a threshold number of card transactions (e.g., credit, debit, and the like), or spends greater than a particular amount per month on a card (e.g., credit, debit, and the like).

(98) The aforementioned features in accordance with aspects of the disclosure and as referenced in FIGS. **1** and **2** may be implemented in a computer system **101**. When computer system **101** receives POS transaction information, the transactions may have a code associated with it that links the transaction to a merchant type. Such a code may be used to determine the matching (i.e., incentive package) for the transaction. For example, an account holder may receive higher matching/bonus for purchases at a particular merchant (in step **208** and **210**), or for particular types of purchases (e.g., bookstore purchases to encourage education, healthcare purchases/costs to encourage good health) (in step **212**). In some instances, a financial institution may waive a maintenance fee (e.g., monthly fee) (in step **214**) based on the number of transactions (e.g., debit card or credit card) or based on the number of dollars spent on purchases. An incentive engine executing in computer system **101** may track the number of transactions on an account (e.g., debit card account) and/or the amount of dollars spent from each account. If an account exceeds a threshold value (in step **208**), an additional bonus/matching (or reward) may be assessed for the account. The incentive engine may be comprised of computer-executable instructions executed by a processor **103** in computer system **101**.

(99) In another embodiment, a merchant matching feature may be included in accordance with aspects of the disclosure. For example, a list of merchants may be provided to an account holder that will cause the account holder to achieve increase matching/bonus levels for his/her savings amount. In one example, the merchants may provide (in step **216**) a portion or all of the matching/bonus funds transferred to the account holder's account for purchases associated with the merchant. As such, the account holder may be motivated to shop with the merchant. One of ordinary skill in the art after review of the present disclosure will appreciate that various features and aspects of the disclosure may be combined with the aforementioned merchant matching feature and such combinations are contemplated by the disclosure. For example the merchant matching feature may be combined with a tiered approach disclosed herein to provide higher levels of matching/bonus for those account holders with increased number of transactions with a merchant or increase amount of total transaction amount with a merchant.

(100) In yet another example, the matching/bonus may depend on the number of products an account holder has with a financial institution. A computer system **101** may include or communicate with the financial institution's user information system. The user information system

may provide information about the overall user relationship (e.g., the number and type of accounts a person has with the institution, how long the person has been an account holder, and the like) and the computer system **101** may determine matching level accordingly. For example, a table in memory **115** at the computer system **101** may link different matching/bonus levels to different levels of user loyalty. A long-time user with a large number of accounts (e.g., auto loan, home loan, home equity loan, investments, deposits, and the like) with substantial balances may be designated at the highest user loyalty level, thus receive a high bonus/matching (e.g., 100% matching).

(101) In yet another example, an account holder may choose to receive the match as reward points that can be redeemed for merchandise, gift cards, airline miles, and the like. For example, the account holder may identify an item they wish to purchase. Once sufficient matching amounts have accumulated for the account holder, a financial institution may contact a merchant selling the product, and procure the product for shipment to the account holder. The account holder may be notified for final approval before the institution makes the final purchase and shipment.

Alternatively, the financial institution may procure the product when the sum of the account holder's savings amount (from automatic transfers through a savings program) and match amount is sufficient to purchase the item.

(102) Finally, in another example, the matching/bonus may be based on online bill pay transactions. As such, an account holder may be provided an incentive to use electronic (i.e., online) bill pay. For example, an account holder that registers for electronic statement in lieu of paper statements may be afforded a higher matching/bonus level than a holder that does not. Likewise, an account holder that registers for direct deposit may be allocated a higher matching/bonus level than a holder that does not. Moreover, a financial institution may encourage its account holders to use direct deposit by increasing (e.g., using the increasing approach) their paycheck amount and other amounts directly deposited with the institution. One skilled in the art will appreciate that other online/electronic services may be afforded a greater incentive among users and prospective users when linked to a higher matching/bonus level.

(103) In another example, the matching (i.e., bonus) paid to the account holder may be based on the account holder growing an account balance over a period of time (e.g., subsequent number of months). For example, an account holder may be paid a particular matching/bonus level for the first 3 months, but if the holder increases the balance of a savings account for the subsequent six month following the first 3 months, a financial institution may retroactively apply a bonus (e.g., 2% interest, and the like) to the first 3 months balance. One skilled in the art will appreciate after review of the present disclosure that there are numerous techniques disclosed for calculating balance for a period of time and may be applied to the aforementioned embodiment. In another example, the account holder may be required to maintain a minimum balance (e.g., \$300) and/or enroll in an automatic scheduled transfer (e.g., a monthly automated transfer of \$25 from a checking to the savings account) to be eligible for the aforementioned retroactively applied bonus feature. Furthermore, in yet another embodiment, if the savings account balance is the same or higher at the one-year anniversary date of enrolling in the savings program, a financial institution may at least double the matching/bonus amount to help grow the savings amount even more.

(104) In yet another embodiment, the match/bonus paid to an account holder may be based on his/her use of online bill pay features. For example, online bill pay transaction codes may be designated in computer system **101** (e.g., by adding the codes to a list of transaction codes identified as eligible for automatic savings and/or matching) to trigger the transfer of automatic savings amounts. Therefore, when such transactions appear on an account holder's statement, the financial institution may determine that an online transaction (e.g., online bill pay transaction or other similar type of online transaction) has occurred, and provide a matching/bonus contribution.

(105) In addition, to encourage additional savings, a financial institution may offer an account holder the option to increase (e.g., double) a matching/bonus level if the account holder enrolls for an automatic scheduled transfer of at least a predetermined amount (e.g., \$25/month) to a saving

account. The matching/bonus level may be phased out such that the account holder receives full matching for a period of time (e.g., the first 3 months), and then a fraction of that amount (e.g., 10%) ongoing thereafter. In another embodiment, the account holder may be required to maintain a minimum deposit amount (e.g., \$300) in his/her savings account in addition to the aforementioned in order to be eligible for the increased matching/bonus level. In another example, if the account holder does not make any withdrawals from the savings account for a period of time (e.g., one year), a financial institution may provide a higher matching level (e.g., double the match from the prior year, increase the matching level for the subsequent year, and the like) In another example, when an account holder deposits large or certain types of funds (e.g., tax refund) into a savings account and does not withdraw the funds for a predefined period of time (e.g., one year), the institution may provide an increased matching/bonus level (e.g., double matching, increased interest rate yield) on the savings amount.

(106) In another example in accordance with aspects of the disclosure, a financial institution may enforce a predefined maximum limit (e.g., \$300) for the matching/bonus amount for a given period of time (e.g., one year). Meanwhile, the institution may match the transferred savings amount at 100% for an initial period of time (e.g., 3 months) and a lower matching level (e.g., 5%) thereafter.

(107) Furthermore, to encourage savings, an account holder and financial institution may identify a period of time (e.g., one year) and a savings amount goal for the holder's savings amount. If the holder achieves the goal, the financial institution may reward the account holder by providing an increased matching level (e.g., double the match from the prior year, increase the matching level for the subsequent year, and the like)

(108) In yet another example, when an account holder regularly pays (e.g., for one consecutive year) at least the minimum amount due on a credit card, a financial institution may increase the level of matching/bonus paid on transferred savings amount. As such, the financial institution encourages good financial management among its account holders. Furthermore, to encourage account holders to maintain a credit card and checking account (or debit card) with the financial institution, the institution may offer an increased matching/bonus level to an account holder commensurate with the amount of interest paid on the holder's credit card. In another embodiment, the financial institution may refund a portion (e.g., 1%, 5%, 20%) of the total amount of interest paid on the holder's credit card over a period of time (e.g., one year) for one or more reasons, including, for example, if the account holder regularly pays at least the minimum amount due on a credit card over the time period.

(109) As explained throughout the disclosure herein, the matching amount may be deposited in a recipient account with a financial institution. Some examples of recipient accounts include savings accounts that have restrictions on the account holder's ability to withdraw funds without early withdrawal charges. In addition, the matching amount may be deposited in various different types of recipient accounts (e.g., gift card account, and the like) Furthermore, in some embodiments, the matching amount may be reward points applied towards airline frequent flier mile programs, or other reward-like programs.

(110) In accordance with various aspects of the disclosure, the matching amount may be paid out at one or more times or regular intervals. For example, a financial institution may pay a bonus at the one-year anniversary of enrolling in the savings program on the balance on the one-year date. As such, an account holder that withdraws money prior to the one-year date may not achieve maximum matching/bonus. In another example, the matching amount may be paid at the end of each day. In yet another example, a matching amount may be paid in "near real-time" as transactions eligible for matching are received at computer system **101**. In yet another example, matching amounts are paid out only after an aggregate match amount threshold (e.g., \$10) has been reached. As such, a financial institution can reduce the number of transfers that are required to implement a savings program in accordance with aspects of the disclosure.

(111) In another embodiment of the present disclosure, after the user selects the recipient accounts

to enroll for receiving savings from the program, the server presents the user with an option to enroll in a service for receiving distribute notifications. If the user selects the distribute notification option, the server then presents to the user options for determining the threshold amount that triggers sending the distribute notifications to the user. The options for determining the threshold level for when the distribute notifications will be sent to the user may be based on an absolute monetary amount of savings from the program, a percentage of savings based on a goal selected by the user, a predetermined passage of time, such as a weekly or monthly distribute notification, or other criterion. When the notification threshold has been reached, the server may then send a notification to the user alerting the user that, among other things, the threshold savings amount has been reached.

(112) Referring to FIG. 7, in step **700**, a debit to a source account (e.g., check card POS, check, and the like) is authorized.

(113) In step **702**, the debit transaction, such as a purchase at POS **162**, disclosed in FIG. 4, using a debit card, may be processed.

(114) In step **704**, the debit transaction may be posted to the source account.

(115) In step **706**, the method of calculating the savings amount may then be determined. In one embodiment, the savings amount may be determined by either a round up, a discount, a merchant or product based savings, a whole monetary amount, a percentage based, a “treat yourself” method, or other criterion. In another embodiment, in reference to FIG. 4, computer server **101**, in communication with the merchants **121**, **122** or **123**, and accompanying POS devices may determine whether a purchase by the user was a discount purchase.

(116) In step **708**, all round up or other savings amounts may be aggregated. This may occur on a daily basis. By aggregating the round ups for one daily posting, exceeding account limits of the source account can be avoided. In one embodiment, the daily posting occurs at the end of the day to further avoid exceeding account limits.

(117) In step **710**, a determination may be made if funds are available in the source account. If not, the aggregated round up debit transaction is cancelled (step **718**) and a \$0.00 transaction is created with a no funds in source account descriptor (step **720**).

(118) In step **712**, the threshold savings level may be determined. In one embodiment of the present disclosure and in reference to FIG. 5, the distribute notification threshold is determined by selective distribution module **1242A** calculating the aggregate savings amount that has not been disbursed to recipient accounts yet. If the threshold level has not been reached, computer system **101** may continue to aggregate savings amount without disbursement (step **722**) to a recipient account until the distribute notification threshold has been reached. Upon reaching the distribute notification threshold amount, the selective distribution module **1242A** may proceed to send the distribution notification and stores this information in memory.

(119) In step **714**, the distribution notification and recipient account selection may be sent to the user. In one embodiment of the present disclosure and in reference to FIG. 5, the distribution notifications are determined by a selective distribution module **1242A** in computer system **101** (e.g., using processor **103A**). Selective distribution module **1242A** determines if the aggregated savings (step **708**) stored in data **121A** has met a pre-determined threshold value as specified by a user in the preceding example. Selective distribution module **1242A** may then send an encrypted distribution notification via a modem in communications module **109A** through WAN **129** to the Internet **131**, and finally to smartphone **171**. Smartphone **171** receives the distribution notification vi.

(120) Internet **131** through communications module **109B** and stores the notification in memory **115B**. Selective distribution module **1242B** in smartphone **171**, using processor **103B** then initiates presenting the distribution notification via audio interface **222**. Audio interface **222** of smartphone **171** receives the notification from selective distribution module **1242B**, and the audio interface then converts the electrical notification into an audible signal to the user via speakers **224** of smartphone

171. After receiving the audible distribution notification, selective distribution module **1242B** then presents a selection input options of recipient accounts for the user to select for distribution of savings. Selective distribution module **1242B** may present the selection input options for recipient accounts via processor **103B** communicating with touchscreen GUI **172** of communications module **109B** of smartphone **171**, to provide a graphical interface for the user to make a selection. (121) In step **716**, the recipient account selections are received. In one embodiment of the disclosure and in reference to FIG. 5, smartphone **171** receives the recipient account selection. Once the user selects the recipient account to receive the distribute savings by touching the corresponding recipient account option via touchscreen GUI **172**, that selection is transmitted through communications module **109B** to selective distribution module **1242B**, where it is then transmitted through communications module **109B** to selective distribution module **1242A** via the Internet **131** and communications module **109**. Upon receiving the recipient account selection information, selective distribution module **1242A** then processes, transforms, and transmits the distribute savings selection information through communications module **109** to a bank server **141** via WAN **129** and Internet **131**. Bank server **141** receives the distribute savings selection information from selective distribution module **1242A**. The distribute savings selection information provides instructions for the bank server **141** to pass on the information to deposit applications and credit engines. The deposit applications debit the savings distribution from the source account, and the credit engines verify the existence and status of the receiving account and create a credit transaction for the transferred savings amount to post to the recipient account in the next processing cycle.

(122) In a further embodiment and in reference to FIG. 5, the distribution notification information sent to the user's wireless device by selective distribution module **1242A** may be transformed into a selective distribution message type. Selective distribution module **1242A** may format the data in the selective distribution message type into an encrypted packet that when decrypted, may include a message identification field, source account fields, recipient account fields, savings amount field, date fields, and selection field, among other fields. As shown in FIG. 17, the selective distribution message type may be illustrated with the aforementioned fields and formalities.

(123) In reference to FIG. 5, the message identification field when read by distribution selection modules **1242A** or **1242B** may identify the message as a selective distribution message type. The source account fields may provide information regarding the source accounts to draw the distribution savings from. Recipient account fields may provide information regarding the recipient account. The savings amount field provides information regarding the distribution savings. The date fields may provide the date range for which the savings aggregate for the distribution threshold notification is drawn from, the date of the distribution notification, the date of distribution selection by the user, the date the distribution savings were posted, among other dates. The selection field may provide information relating to the source accounts and recipient accounts that were selected for the distribution savings, as a user may identify multiple source and recipient accounts for a distribution savings. The fields may provide sufficient information so when parsed and transformed by distribution module **1242A** and distribution module **1242B** to provide banking server **141** or **151** the information needed to obtain any data requests of the selected source and recipient accounts without need for selective distribution modules **1242B** to be present at the bank servers to process the data. At least one technological benefit to this arrangement is that the selective distribution module **1242B** may separate multiple transfer requests into a plurality of messages that can be scalably distributed to a plurality of banking servers for processing. As such, the processing load may be shared among a server farm of banking servers.

(124) Additionally, the recipient account selection information sent by selective distribution module **1242B** to selective distribution module **1242A** may also be transformed into a selective distribution message type. Similarly to the embodiment described above, this selective distribution message type may be formatted by transforming and encrypting the data packets into a selective distribution

message type containing message identification field, source account fields, recipient account fields, savings amount field, date fields, and selection fields, among other fields. This may allow the distribution selection modules **1242A** to parse the recipient account selection information once received from distribution module **1242B**, splice the data, repackage, and transmit the relevant data so as to send to bank servers **141** or **151** of the necessary financial institutions to perform the debits and credits to the selected source and recipient accounts without need for selective distribution modules **1242B** to be present at the bank servers to process the data from distribution selection modules **1242A**.

(125) Additionally, as the distribution notification information and recipient account selection information may be transformed into selective distribution message types, bank servers **141** and **151** may also have selective distribution modules **1242B** so as to process the selective distribution message types without need for selective distribution module **1242A** in computer server **101** to transform the selective distribution message type into code readable by the bank servers without selective distribution modules **1242B**. In this embodiment, bank servers **141** and **151** may then be able to transform the data for communicating with a variety of other bank and computer servers at other financial institutions and retail locations, among other computers.

(126) One of ordinary skill in the art after review of the entirety disclosed herein and in reference to FIG. 5, will appreciate that various features and aspects of the disclosure allow the user to receive distribution notifications by other wireless devices besides smartphone **171**. The user may also associate other devices with the source account to communicate with selective distribution module **1242A** in computer system **101** for receiving distribution notifications and for allowing the user to select recipient accounts, such as a user's personal computer **161**, tablet **181**, or smartwatch **191**. Any personal wireless device capable of communicating with computer server **101** and selective distribution module **1242A** may be used.

(127) In a further embodiment of the present disclosure, smartwatch **191** may receive distribution notifications from selective distribution module **1242A** in computer server **101** via communications module **109B**. Smartwatch **191** may not have selective distribution module **1242B**, but upon receiving the distribution notifications in communications module **109B**, directly present the notification to the user via a graphical message on the smartwatch GUI in communications module **109B**, or as an audio alert through a speaker in communications module **109B** in smartwatch **191**. The smartwatch **191** may present any combination of graphical, audio, or vibration distribution notifications alerts to a user.

(128) Further, smartwatch **191** may allow for the user to make a recipient account selection at the smartwatch touchscreen GUI **172** and then communicate that selection to selective distribution module **1242A** via communications module **109B** in smartwatch **191**, or it may communicate with another wireless device for the user to make a recipient account selection. For example, upon receiving distribution notification from distribution module **1242A**, the smartwatch alerts the user. Then, smartwatch **191** communicates the distribution notification with another wireless device of the user, such as tablet **181**, which then presents the recipient account selection input to the user.

(129) In accordance with various aspects of the disclosure and in reference to FIG. 5, the distribution notification presented to the user may be communicated in various forms. For example, after the wireless device of the user receives the distribution notification, it may present the notification via vibration of the wireless device. Selective distribution module **1242B** of the wireless device, upon receiving the distribution notification, would send the notification signal to a motor within communications module **109B** that activates the motor and causes vibration within the wireless device. In another example, the distribution module **1242B** upon receiving the distribution notification would transmit a text or image graphical alert through a GUI of the communications module **109B**.

(130) Further, selective distribution module **1242B** may receive the user input for selection of the recipient accounts through additional means. For example, upon presenting the user with recipient

account selections through a GUI in communications module **109B** of the wireless device, the user may select the recipient account through voice activation. Selective distribution module **1242B** may transmit the recipient account selection information to the GUI via processor **103B** with corresponding voice activation phrases for each account, such as “account A” or “grandson's account”. When the user speaks one of the voice activation phrases for an account, a microphone within the communications module **109B** may detect the phrase and then send that selection information to selective distribution module **1242B**.

(131) In another example, the user may select a recipient account through a GUI in the wireless device via a keyboard or mouse in communications module **109B**. Still further, selective distribution module **1242B** may have pre-selected recipient accounts stored in memory **115B** that the user has selected at enrollment in the savings program, and selective distribution module **1242B** will automatically select the pre-selected recipient account after sending a distribution notification to the user.

(132) One of ordinary skill in the art after review of the entirety disclosed herein will appreciate that the user's mobile device may receive the recipient accounts information through a number of means. For example, in one embodiment, the selective distribution module **1242B** of the wireless device may have the recipient account information stored on the mobile device in memory **115B**. In this embodiment, upon receiving the distribution notification, selective distribution module **1242B** of the wireless device would then retrieve the recipient accounts information from memory **115B** to present the recipient account selection input to the user. In another embodiment, the selective distribution module **1242B** receives the recipient account information from computer server **101** along with the distribution notification. The selective distribution module **1242A** may encrypt the recipient account information and then transmit this information over the Internet **131** through communications module **109A** to the wireless device. Once the wireless device has received the encrypted recipient account information, selective distribution module **1242B** then decrypts the information and sends this information to communication module **109B** for presenting to the user for selection. In a still further embodiment, the wireless device may communicate directly with bank server **141** for receiving the recipient account information.

(133) In accordance with various aspects of the disclosure and in reference to FIG. 5, the selective distribution module **1242A** may exist within a bank server **141** or **151** of a financial institution, such that the selective distribution module **1242A** exists within memory **115A** of bank server **141** or **151**. Distribute notifications and recipient account selection information may then be transmitted directly between bank server **141** or **151** to the user's wireless device. When selective distribution module **1242A** in bank server **141** or **151** receives the recipient account selection from the user's wireless device, selective distribution module **1242A** through processor **103** then posts the debit of the distribution savings from the source account and posts the credit of the distribution savings to the recipient account in data **121**.

(134) Alternatively, the user's wireless device may not contain selective distribution module **1242B** within memory **115B**. Selective distribution module **1242A** may transmit and present both selective distribution notifications and recipient account selections, as well as receive recipient account inputs from the user through the wireless device. Selective distribution module **1242A** may communicate wirelessly with communications module **109B** in the wireless device to directly send distribution notification signals to the user, as well as sending recipient account selection information directly to the user through communications module **109B**. Additionally, when the user makes a recipient account selection, that selection may be transmitted directly from communications module **109B** to the computers server **101** for processing by selective distribution module **1242A**. In this sense, the user's wireless device is operating as a portal for presenting and receiving selective distribution information from selective distribution module **1242A** without requiring selective distribution module **1242B** on the wireless device.

(135) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, computer server **101** presents an option for the

user to enroll in a service for receiving additional savings notifications. The additional savings notification may prompt the user to add additional funds to the selected savings amounts. The additional amount may be added to a daily savings amount. In another embodiment, the additional savings amount may be added at other time frames, such as weekly or monthly. The user may select any whole monetary amount, among other amounts, to add to the savings round up amounts when prompted by an additional savings notification. The user may additionally select periodic time periods to send additional savings notifications to the user in the future.

(136) In a further embodiment, the additional savings notification may be sent by computer server **101** in conjunction with sending the savings notification notifying the user that they are not reaching their savings goals. The server may also suggest an additional savings amount or additional savings method to add to the savings amounts or savings methods based on the users selected goal and the projection of achieving that goal within a selected time frame.

(137) Referring to FIG. **8**, an embodiment of a computer implemented savings program for providing additional savings notifications is shown. In step **700**, the debit to the source account (e.g., check card POS, check, and the like) selected at **102** is authorized.

(138) In step **702**, the debit transaction, such as a purchase at POS **162** disclosed in FIG. **4**, using a debit card, may be processed.

(139) In step **704**, the debit transaction may be posted to the source account.

(140) In step **800**, the daily posting transaction begins.

(141) In step **706**, the method of calculating the savings amount may be determined. In one embodiment, the savings amount may be determined by either a round up, a discount, a merchant or product based savings, a whole monetary amount, a percentage based, a “treat yourself” method, or other criterion. In another embodiment, with reference to elements depicted in FIG. **4**, the computer server **101**, in communication with the merchants **164**, **165** or **166**, and accompanying POS devices **162** may determine whether a purchase by the user was a discount purchase.

(142) In step **708**, all round up or other amounts may be aggregated. This may occur on a daily basis. By aggregating the round ups for one daily posting, exceeding account limits of the source account can be avoided. In one embodiment, the daily posting may occur at the end of the day to further avoid exceeding account limits.

(143) In step **710**, a determination may be made if funds are available in the source account. If not, the aggregated round up debit transaction may be cancelled (step **718**) and a \$0.00 transaction is created with a no funds in source account descriptor (step **720**).

(144) In step **802**, with reference to elements depicted in FIG. **5**, the additional savings module **843A** may determine if the savings are on track to meeting the user's savings goal. Additional savings module **843** determines the daily savings needed to meet the user's selected goal by the given time frame by the user. If the user is on track as of that day, then the additional savings module **843A** may proceed to step **808**. If the user is not on track, then additional savings module **843** may send a request for additional savings **804**.

(145) In step **804**, the additional savings notification may be sent to the user. In one embodiment of the present disclosure, with reference to elements depicted in FIG. **5**, the additional savings notifications may be determined by an additional savings module **843A** in computer system **101** (e.g., using processor **103A**). Additional savings module **843A** determines if the aggregated savings **408** stored in data **121A** has met a daily threshold value as specified by a user's end goals and calculated by additional savings module **843A** in the preceding example. Additional savings module **843A** may then send an encrypted additional savings notification via a modem in communications module **109A** through WAN **129** to the Internet **131**, and finally to smartphone **171**. Smartphone **171** receives the additional savings notification via Internet **131** through communications module **109B** and stores the notification in memory **115B**. Additional savings module **843B** in smartphone **171**, using processor **103B** then initiates presenting the additional savings notification via audio interface **222**. Audio interface **222** of smartphone **171** receives the

notification from additional savings module **843B**, and the audio interface may then convert the electrical notification into an audible signal to the user via speakers **224** of smartphone **171**. After receiving the audible additional savings notification, additional savings module **843B** may then presents a selection input options for additional savings for the user to select to add to the savings amount. Additionally, savings module **843B** may present the selection input options for additional savings via touchscreen GUI **172** by processor **103B** communicating with communications module **109B** of smartphone **171** to provide a graphical interface for the user to make a selection.

(146) In step **806**, the additional savings selections may be received. In one embodiment of the disclosure, with reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, smartphone **171** receives the additional savings selections. Once the user selects the additional savings selections by touching the corresponding additional savings option via touchscreen GUI **172**, that selection may be transmitted through communications module **109B** to additional savings module **843B**, where it is then transmitted through communications module **109B** to additional savings module **843A** of computer server **101** via the Internet **131** and communications module **109**. Upon receiving the additional savings selections, additional savings module **843A** may then determine a new savings amount.

(147) In step **808**, the additional savings module **843A** may determine if the user is on track to meet a savings goal based on an intermediate time period. With reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, the intermediate time period may be a monthly time period since enrollment, in which additional savings module **843A** checks the total savings since enrollment and determines if the user is on track to reach the final savings goal based on the user's intermediate time period, which in one embodiment may be a monthly savings total. If additional savings module **843A** determines that the user has not met the intermediate savings goal, the additional savings module **843A** may send an additional savings method notification **810**. If the user has met the intermediate savings goal, but required additional savings request **804**, additional savings module **843A** may transform and transmits the additional savings selections information through communications module **109** to a bank server **141** via WAN **129** and Internet **131**. Bank server **141** may receive the additional savings selections information from additional savings module **843A**. Additional savings module **843A** provides instructions for bank server **141** to pass on the information to deposit applications for debiting the additional savings selections information from the source account and to credit engines for verifying the existence and status of the receiving account. Bank server **141** may then create a credit transaction for the additional savings selections information to post to the recipient account in the next processing cycle. If the user's savings are on track and did not require additional savings notification **804** or additional savings method notification **801**, additional savings module **843A** may transmit the savings amount through communications module **109** to a bank server **141** via WAN **129** and Internet **131** for posting the savings amount as in the proceeding example described above.

(148) In step **810**, the additional savings method notification may be sent to the user. In one embodiment of the present disclosure and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, the additional savings method notification may be determined by an additional savings module **843A** in computer system **101** (e.g., using processor **103**). Additional savings module **843A** may then send an encrypted additional savings method notification via a modem in communications module **109A** through WAN **129** to the Internet **131**, and finally to smartphone **171**. Smartphone **171** receives the additional savings method notification via Internet **131** through communications module **109B** and stores the notification in memory **115B**. Additional savings module **843B** in smartphone **171**, using processor **103B** may then initiate presenting the additional savings method notification via audio interface **222**. Audio interface **222** of smartphone **171** receives the notification from additional savings module **843B**, and the audio interface may then convert the electrical notification into an audible signal to the user via speakers **224** of smartphone **171**. After receiving the audible additional savings method notification, additional savings module **843B** may then present a

selection input option for additional savings method for the user to select to add or alter the savings method of **406** and **804**. Additional savings module **843B** may present the selection input options for additional savings methods via touchscreen GUI **172** by processor **103B** communicating with communications module **109B** of smartphone **171** to provide a graphical interface for the user to make a selection.

(149) In step **812**, the additional savings method selections may be received. In one embodiment of the disclosure and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, smartphone **171** receives the additional savings method selections. Once the user selects the additional savings method selections by touching the corresponding additional savings method option via touchscreen GUI **172**, those selections may be transmitted through communications module **109B** to additional savings module **843B**, where it is then transmitted through communications module **109B** to additional savings module **843A** of computer server **101** via the Internet **131** and communications module **109**. Upon receiving the additional savings method selections, additional savings module **843A** may then determine a new savings method amount. Additional savings module **843A** may then transmit the savings amount through communications module **109** to a bank server **141** via WAN **129** and Internet **131** for posting the savings amount as in the proceeding example described above.

(150) One of ordinary skill in the art after review of the present disclosure will appreciate that various features and aspects of the disclosure may allow additional savings module **843A** to present a number of additional savings amounts for the user to select at the wireless device in step **804** and **806**. The additional saving amounts may be an amount recommended by additional savings module **843A** that is calculated to meet the user's daily savings amount to reach the user's selected goal during enrollment. Further, the wireless device in communication with additional savings module **843A** may present the option for the user to specify a custom additional savings amount. The additional savings amount may be a whole monetary amount, a percentage of the user's savings amount, or any other criterion that a banking server may be able to process.

(151) Similarly, and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, additional savings module **843A** in communication with a wireless device of the user may present a number of additional savings methods for the user to select at the wireless device in step **810** and **812**. Additional savings module **843A** may present additional savings methods that have been described at previous step **406**, such as discount savings, product or merchant based savings, whole monetary amount savings, round up savings, or other methods of savings amounts. Additional savings module **843A** may calculate and recommend preferred savings methods for the user based on obtaining a user's specified savings goal.

(152) In one embodiment, the additional savings notification sent to the user's wireless device by additional savings module **843A** may be transformed into an additional savings message type. Additional savings module **843A** may format the data in the additional savings message type into an encrypted packet that when decrypted, may include a message identification field, source account fields, recipient account fields, savings amount fields, date fields, and selection fields, among other fields. As shown in FIG. 17, the additional savings message type is illustrated with the aforementioned fields and formalities.

(153) Referring to FIG. 17, the message identification field **1700** when read by additional savings module **843A** or **843B**, may identify the message as an additional savings message type. The source account field **1702** may provide information regarding the source accounts to draw the additional savings from. Recipient account field **1704** may provide information regarding the recipient account. The savings amount field **1706** may provide information regarding the additional savings options. The date field **1708** may provide the date range for which the savings aggregate for the distribution threshold notification is drawn from, the date of the distribution notification, the date of distribution selection by the user, the date the distribution savings were posted, among other dates. The selection field **1710** may provide information relating to the source accounts and

recipient accounts that were selected for the distribution savings, as a user may identify multiple source and recipient accounts for a distribution savings. Additional fields **1712** may provide additional information regarding multiple additional savings transactions between multiple source and recipient accounts. Additional savings module **843A** or additional savings module **843B** may parse and transform the additional savings message type before being sent to banking server **141** or **151**. This conversion of the additional savings message into a readable format by bank servers **141** and **151** obviates the need for selective additional savings module **843B** to be present at the bank servers to process the message. Further, the information within the fields of the additional savings message may provide sufficient information, so when parsed and transformed by additional savings module **843A** or additional savings module **843B**, provide sufficient information for bank servers **141** or **151** to create or update a savings debit or credit transaction without need to query additional data from the selected source and recipient accounts. At least one technological benefit to this arrangement is that the selective distribution module **1242B** may separate multiple transfer requests into a plurality of messages that can be scalably distributed to a plurality of banking servers for processing. As such, the processing load may be shared among a server farm of banking servers. (154) Additionally, the additional savings selection information sent by additional savings module **843B** to additional savings module **843A** may also be transformed into an additional savings message type. Similarly to the embodiment described above, this additional savings message type may be formatted by transforming and encrypting the data packets into an additional savings message type that may contain message identification field, source account fields, recipient account fields, savings amount fields, date fields, and selection fields, among other fields as described in the proceeding example. This may allow the distribution selection modules **1242A** to parse the recipient account selection information once received from distribution module **1242B**, splice the data, repackage, and transmit the relevant data so as to send to bank servers **141** or **151**. Bank servers **141** or **151** may then perform the debits and credits to the selected source and recipient accounts without need for additional savings module **843B** to be present at the bank servers to process the data from additional savings module **843A**.

(155) In another embodiment, in reference to FIG. 5, bank servers **141** and **151** may also have additional savings module **843B** so as to process the additional savings message type without need for additional savings module **843A** in computer server **101** to transform the message type into code readable by the bank servers without additional savings modules **843B**. In this embodiment, bank servers **141** and **151** may then be able to transform the data for communicating with a variety of other bank and computer servers at other financial institutions and retail locations, among other computers.

(156) One of ordinary skill in the art after review of the present disclosure will appreciate that various features and aspects of the disclosure allow the user to receive additional savings and additional savings method notifications by other wireless devices besides smartphone **171**. The user may also associate other devices with the source account to communicate with additional savings module **843A** in computer system **101** for receiving additional savings and additional savings method notifications and for allowing the user to select additional savings and additional savings methods, such as a user's personal computer **161**, tablet **181**, or smartwatch **191**. Any personal wireless device capable of communicating with computer server **101** and additional savings module **843A** may be used.

(157) In a further embodiment of the present disclosure, smartwatch **191** may receive additional savings or additional savings method notifications from additional savings module **843A** in computer server **101** via communications module **109B**. Smartwatch **191** may not have additional savings module **843B**, but upon receiving the additional savings or additional savings method notifications in communications module **109B**, directly present the notifications to the user via a graphical message on the smartwatch GUI in communications module **109B**, or as an audio alert through a speaker in communications module **109B** in smartwatch **191**. The smartwatch **191** may

present any combination of graphical, audio, or vibration distribution notifications alerts to a user. (158) Further, smartwatch **191** may allow for the user to make an additional savings or additional savings method selection at the smartwatch touchscreen GUI **172** and then communicate that selection to additional savings module **843A** via communications module **109B** in smartwatch **191**, or it may communicate with another wireless device for the user to make an additional savings or additional savings method selection. For example, upon receiving additional savings or additional savings method selection from additional savings module **843A**, the smartwatch alerts the user. Then, smartwatch **191** communicates the additional savings or additional savings method notification with another wireless device of the user, such as tablet **181**, which then presents additional savings or additional savings method selection input to the user.

(159) In accordance with various aspects of the disclosure, the additional savings or additional savings method notifications presented to the user may be communicated in various forms. For example, after the wireless device of the user receives the notification, it may present the notification via vibration of the wireless device. Additional savings module **843B** of the wireless device, upon receiving the additional savings or additional savings method notification, would send the notification signal to a motor within communications module **109B** that activates the motor and causes vibration within the wireless device. In another example, the additional savings module **843B** upon receiving the additional savings or additional savings method notification would transmit a text or image graphical alert through a GUI of the communications module **109B**.

(160) Further, additional savings module **843B** may receive the user input for selection of the additional savings or additional savings method through additional means. For example, upon presenting the user with additional savings or additional savings method selections through a GUI in communications module **109B** of the wireless device, the user may select the recipient account through voice activation. Additional savings module **843B** may transmit the additional savings or additional savings method selection information to the GUI via processor **103B** with corresponding voice activation phrases for each additional savings or additional savings method, such as “five dollar additional amount” or “merchant based savings method”. When the user speaks one of the voice activation phrases for an account, a microphone within the communications module **109B** may detect the phrase and then send that selection information to additional savings module **843B**. (161) In another example, the user may select a recipient account through a GUI in the wireless device via a keyboard or mouse in communications module **109B**.

(162) One of ordinary skill in the art after review of the present disclosure will appreciate that the user's mobile device may receive the additional savings information through a number of means. For example, in one embodiment and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, the additional savings module **843B** of the wireless device may have the additional savings information stored on the mobile device in memory **115B**. In this embodiment, upon receiving the additional savings or additional savings method notification, additional savings module **843B** of the wireless device would then retrieve the additional savings or additional savings method information from memory **115B** to present the additional savings or additional savings method input to the user. In another embodiment, the additional savings module **843B** receives the additional savings or additional savings method information from computer server **101** along with the additional savings or additional savings method notification. The additional savings module **843A** may encrypt the additional savings or additional savings method information and then transmit this information over the Internet **131** through communications module **109A** to the wireless device. Once the wireless device has received the encrypted additional savings or additional savings method information, additional savings module **843B** then decrypts the information and sends this information to communication module **109B** for presenting to the user for selection. In a still further embodiment, the wireless device may communicate directly with bank server **141** for receiving the additional savings or additional savings method information.

(163) In accordance with various aspects of the disclosure, the additional savings module **843A**

may exist within a bank server **141** or **151** of a financial institution, such that the additional savings module **843A** exists within memory **115A** of bank server **141** or **151**. Additional savings or additional savings method information may then be transmitted directly between bank server **141** or **151** to the user's wireless device. When additional savings module **843A** in bank server **141** or **151** receives the additional savings or additional savings method information from the user's wireless device, additional savings module **843A** through processor **103** then posts the debit of the additional savings from the source account and posts the credit of the additional savings to the recipient account in data **121**.

(164) Alternatively, the user's wireless device may not contain additional savings module **843B** within memory **115B**. Additional savings module **843A** may transmit and present both additional savings and additional savings method notifications, as well as receive additional savings or additional savings method inputs from the user through the wireless device. Additional savings module **843A** may communicate wirelessly with communications module **109B** in the wireless device to directly send additional savings or additional savings method notification signals to the user. Further, when the user makes an additional savings or additional savings method selection, that selection may be transmitted directly from communications module **109B** to the computers server **101** for processing by additional savings module **843A**. In this sense, the user's wireless device is operating as a portal for presenting and receiving additional savings or additional savings method information from additional savings module **843A** without requiring additional savings module **843B** on the wireless device.

(165) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, the user may enroll in a service to receive savings goal indicators. If the user enrolls in the savings goal indicator service, computer system **101** may periodically determine the total savings amounts saved from the source account since the user enrolled, and compare the total amounts to the users selected goal. If the server determines that the user has not reached their goal or is not on track to reach their goal, the server may send a savings notification alert to the user. In a further embodiment, the savings notification alert may be sent from computer system **101** to the users selected device, and the alert may be voice activated, text, vibration, audio, or a graphical prompt. Alternatively, the server may also determine if the user is on track to reach their goal by determining if the user has reached any identified intermediate goals, or the server may determine if the user is on track based on the a projection from the time remaining to reach the goal and the amount of total savings accumulated.

(166) In another embodiment of the present disclosure, computer system **101** may periodically send savings notifications updating the user on the amount they have saved in the program and/or the progress the user has made toward achieving their savings goal. Computer server **101** may automatically send updates periodically, or based on a time frame selected by the user.

(167) Referring to FIG. **9**, an embodiment of a computer implemented savings program for providing a savings goal indicator is shown. In step **700**, the debit to a source account (e.g., check card POS, check, and the like) is authorized.

(168) In step **702**, the debit transaction, such as a purchase at POS **162** using a debit card, may be processed.

(169) In step **704**, the debit transaction may be posted to the source account.

(170) In step **800**, the daily posting transaction begins.

(171) In step **708**, all round up or other amounts may be aggregated. This may occur on a daily, weekly, or other time basis. By aggregating the round ups for one daily or other selected time period for posting, exceeding account limits of the source account can be avoided. In one embodiment, the daily posting may occur at the end of the day to further avoid exceeding account limits.

(172) In step **710**, a determination may be made if funds are available in the source account. If not, the aggregated round up debit transaction may be cancelled (step **718**) and a \$0.00 transaction is created with a no funds in source account descriptor (step **720**).

(173) In step **900**, the savings goal module **944A** may determine if the savings amount has reached a savings goal notification threshold. Savings goal module **944A** determines the use's total savings amount to date, and compares that savings amount to the notification threshold. The notification threshold may be determined by the user's savings goal, including reaching certain percentages of the savings goal, as well as the end savings goal. If the user has reached a savings goal notification threshold, then savings goal module **944A** may proceed to step **902** to notify the user. If the user has not reached the savings goal notification threshold, then savings goal module **944A** proceeds to step **904**.

(174) In step **902**, savings goal module **944A** may send a savings goal notification to the user. In one embodiment of the present disclosure as disclosed by FIG. 5, savings goal module **944A** may send an encrypted savings goal notification via a modem in communications module **109A** through WAN **129** to the Internet **131**, and finally to smartphone **171**. Smartphone **171** receives the savings goal notification via Internet **131** through communications module **109B** and stores the notification in memory **115B**. Savings goal module **944B** in smartphone **171**, using processor **103B** then initiates presenting the savings goal notification via audio interface **222**. Audio interface **222** of smartphone **171** receives the notification from savings goal module **944B**, and the audio interface may then convert the electrical notification into an audible signal to the user via speakers **224** of smartphone **171**.

(175) In step **904**, the savings goal module **944A** may determine if the time period has lapsed for the user to meet the periodic save goal. In one embodiment of the present disclosure and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, savings goal module **944A** may determine if a time period has lapsed for sending a periodic savings goal notification. Savings goal module **944A** may retrieve this information stored in memory **115A** providing the time period between savings goal updates, based on the users selected savings goal during enrollment. If savings goal module **944A** determines that the time period for a savings goal update notification has lapsed, it may send a notification to the user.

(176) In step **906**, the savings goal module **944A** may send a savings goal update notification to the user. In one embodiment of the present disclosure and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, savings goal module **944A** may send an encrypted savings goal update notification via a modem in communications module **109A** through WAN **129** to the Internet **131**, and finally to smartphone **171**. Smartphone **171** receives the savings goal update notification via internet **131** through communications module **109B** and stores the notification in memory **115B**. Savings goal module **944B** in smartphone **171**, using processor **103B** then initiates presenting the savings goal update notification via audio interface **222**. Audio interface **222** of smartphone **171** receives the notification from savings goal module **944B**, and the audio interface may then convert the electrical notification into an audible signal to the user via speakers **224** of smartphone **171**. After receiving the audible savings goal update notification, savings goal module **944B** may then present a selection input options for updating the user's savings goal as defined by the user at enrollment. Savings goal module **944B** may present the selection input options for updating their savings goals via touchscreen GUI **172** by processor **103B** communicating with communications module **109B** of smartphone **171** to provide a graphical interface for the user to make a selection.

(177) In step **908**, the savings goal update selection may be received. In one embodiment of the disclosure and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, smartphone **171** receives the savings goal update selection. Once the user selects the savings goal update selections by touching the corresponding savings goal update options via touchscreen GUI **172**, that selection may be transmitted through communications module **109B** to savings goal module **944B**, where it is then transmitted through communications module **109B** to savings goal module **944A** of computer server **101** via the Internet **131** and communications module **109**. Upon receiving the savings goal update selection, savings goal module **944B** may then determine a new savings amount notification threshold **900**.

(178) In step **910**, the savings goal module **944A** updates the savings distribution to the user's recipient accounts. In the case where the user has identified multiple recipient accounts to enroll in the savings program or multiple savings goals, the savings goal module **944A** determines what percentage of the savings may go to each recipient account for the savings. In another embodiment, where savings goal module **944A** determines that one savings goal has been reached, savings goal module **944A** may then provide banking server **141** or **151** information so as to divert additional savings into other recipient accounts or other savings goals selected by the user.

(179) One of ordinary skill in the art after review of the present disclosure will appreciate that various features and aspects of the disclosure may allow savings goal module **944A** to present a number of savings goal selections for the user to select at the wireless device in step **906**. The savings goal selections may be a recommended periodic savings goal determined by savings goal module **944A** that is calculated to meet the user's selected end goal during enrollment. Further, the wireless device in communication with additional savings module **843A** may present the option for the user to specify a custom periodic or end goal savings amount. Still further, in another embodiment of the present disclosure, the user may select multiple savings goals for multiple recipient accounts, such that different recipient accounts may have different savings goals and different savings notification thresholds, and also different periodic savings goal update time periods. When presented with a savings goal update notification as in step **906**, the user may update and alter the savings goals, notification amounts, or periodic update time frames for different recipient accounts at step **908** of the present disclosure.

(180) In one embodiment, the savings goal update notification sent to the user's wireless device by savings goal module **944A** may be transformed into a savings goal update message type. Savings goal module **944A** may format the data in the savings goal update message type into an encrypted packet that when decrypted, may include a message identification field, source account fields, recipient account fields, savings goal fields, date fields, and selection fields, among other fields. As shown in FIG. **17**, the savings goal update message type may be illustrated with the aforementioned fields and formalities.

(181) Referring to FIG. **17**, the message identification field **1700**, when read by savings goal module **944A** or **944B**, may identify the message as a savings goal update message type. The source account field **1702** may provide information regarding the source accounts connected to determining the savings totals and savings goals from. The recipient account field **1704** may provide information relating to the recipient accounts connected to receiving the savings amounts toward the user's savings goals. The savings goal field **1714** provides information regarding the additional savings options. The date field **1708** may provide the date range for which the savings aggregate for the savings goal notifications are drawn from, the date of the savings goal notifications, the date of savings goal selections by the user, and the date the savings goals were reached, among other dates. The selection field **1710** may provide information relating to the source accounts and recipient accounts that were selected for the savings goals, as a user may identify multiple source and recipient accounts for a distribution savings. Referring to elements disclosed in FIG. **5**, savings goal module **944A** or **944B** may parse and transform the savings goal update message before being sent to banking server **141** or **151**. This conversion of the savings goal update message into a readable format by bank servers **141** and **151** obviates the need for savings goal module **944B** to be present at the bank servers to process the message. Further, the information within the fields of savings goal update message may provide sufficient information, so when parsed and transformed by savings goal module **944A** or savings goal module **944B**, provide sufficient information for bank servers **141** or **151** to create or update savings debit or credit transactions between source and recipient accounts without need to query additional data from the selected source and recipient accounts. At least one technological benefit to this arrangement is that the savings goal module **944B** may separate multiple savings update requests into a plurality of messages that can be scalably distributed to a plurality of banking servers for

processing. As such, the processing load may be shared among a server farm of banking servers. (182) In another embodiment, bank servers **141** and **151** may also have savings goal module **944B** so as to process the savings goal update message type without need for savings goal module **944A** in computer server **101** to transform the message type into code readable by the bank servers without savings goal module **944B**. In this embodiment, bank servers **141** and **151** may then be able to transform the data for communicating with a variety of other bank and computer servers at other financial institutions and retail locations, among other computers.

(183) One of ordinary skill in the art after review of the present disclosure will appreciate that various features and aspects of the disclosure allow the user to receive savings goal and savings goal update notifications by other wireless devices besides smartphone **171**. The user may also associate other devices with the source account to communicate with savings goal module **944A** in computer system **101** for receiving savings goal and savings goal update notifications and for allowing the user to select savings goal updates, such as a user's personal computer **161**, tablet **181**, or smartwatch **191**. Any personal wireless device capable of communicating with computer server **101** and savings goal module **944A** may be used.

(184) In a further embodiment of the present disclosure, smartwatch **191** may receive savings goal and savings goal update notifications from savings goal module **944A** in computer server **101** via communications module **109B**. Smartwatch **191** may not have savings goal module **944B**, but upon receiving the savings goal or savings goal update notifications in communications module **109B**, directly present the notifications to the user via a graphical message on the smartwatch GUI in communications module **109B**, or as an audio alert through a speaker in communications module **109B** in smartwatch **191**. The smartwatch **191** may present any combination of graphical, audio, vibration, or other method of distribution notifications alerts to a user.

(185) Further, smartwatch **191** may allow for the user to make a savings goal update selection at the smartwatch touchscreen GUI **172** and then communicate that selection to savings goal module **944A** via communications module **109B** in smartwatch **191**, or communicate with another wireless device for the user to make a savings goal update selection. For example, upon receiving a savings goal update selection from savings goal module **944A**, the smartwatch alerts the user. Then, smartwatch **191** communicates the savings goal update notification with another wireless device of the user, such as tablet **181**, which then presents savings goal update selection input to the user.

(186) In accordance with various aspects of the disclosure, the savings goal and savings goal update notifications presented to the user may be communicated in various forms. For example, after the wireless device of the user receives the notification, it may present the notification via vibration of the wireless device. Savings goal module **944B** of the wireless device, upon receiving the savings goal and savings goal update notification, would send the notification signal to a motor within communications module **109B** that activates the motor and causes vibration within the wireless device. In another example, the savings goal module **944B** upon receiving the savings goal and savings goal update notification would transmit a text or image graphical alert through a GUI of the communications module **109B**.

(187) Further, savings goal module **944B** may receive the user input for selection of the savings goal update through additional means. For example, upon presenting the user with savings goal update selections through a GUI in communications module **109B** of the wireless device, the user may select the savings goal update amount through voice activation. Savings goal module **944B** may transmit the savings goal update selection information to the GUI via processor **103B** with corresponding voice activation phrases for each savings goal update, such as “five hundred dollars,” or “option A”. When the user speaks one of the voice activation phrases for an account, a microphone within the communications module **109B** may detect the phrase and then send that selection information to savings goal module **944B**.

(188) In another example, the user may select a recipient account through a GUI in the wireless device via a keyboard or mouse in communications module **109B**.

(189) One of ordinary skill in the art after review of the present disclosure will appreciate that the user's mobile device may receive the savings goal information through a number of means. For example, in one embodiment, the savings goal module **944B** of the wireless device may have the savings goal information stored on the mobile device in memory **115B**. In this embodiment, upon receiving the savings goal or savings goal update notification, savings goal module **944B** of the wireless device would then retrieve the savings goal and savings goal update information from memory **115B** to present the savings goal and savings goal update selection input options to the user. In another embodiment, savings goal module **944B** receives the savings goal and savings goal update information from computer server **101** along with the savings goal or savings goal update notification. The savings goal module **944A** may encrypt the savings goal or savings goal update information and then transmit this information over the Internet **131** through communications module **109A** to the wireless device. Once the wireless device has received the encrypted savings goal or savings goal update information, savings goal module **944B** then decrypts the information and sends this information to communication module **109B** for presenting to the user for selection. In a still further embodiment, the wireless device may communicate directly with bank server **141** for receiving the savings goal or savings goal update information.

(190) In accordance with various aspects of the disclosure, savings goal module **944A** as part of computer system **101** may exist within a bank server **141** or **151** of a financial institution, such that savings goal module **944A** exists within memory **115A** of bank server **141** or **151**. Additional savings or additional savings method information may then be transmitted directly between bank server **141** or **151** to the user's wireless device. When savings goal module **944A** in bank server **141** or **151** receives the additional savings or additional savings method information from the user's wireless device, savings goal module **944A** through processor **103** then posts the debit of the additional savings from the source account and posts the credit of the additional savings to the recipient account in database **121A**.

(191) Alternatively, the user's wireless device may not contain savings goal module **944B** within memory **115B**. Savings goal module **944A** may transmit and present both additional savings and additional savings method notifications, as well as receive additional savings or additional savings method inputs from the user through the wireless device. Savings goal module **944A** may communicate wirelessly with communications module **109B** in the wireless device to directly send additional savings or additional savings method notification signals to the user. Further, when the user makes an additional savings or additional savings method selection, that selection may be transmitted directly from communications module **109B** to the computer server **101** for processing by savings goal module **944B**. In this sense, the user's wireless device is operating as a portal for presenting and receiving additional savings or additional savings method information from savings goal module **944A** without requiring additional savings module **843B** on the wireless device.

(192) In one embodiment, the user may enroll in a merchant or product based saving method service. The savings amount may be determined by a merchant or product based savings method. The merchant or product savings method may be based on funds saved from spending less on a non-preferred merchant or product compared to a user's preferred or historical purchasing behavior for analogous products or merchants. In one example, if a user typically purchases a preferred product, such as a preferred brand and type of cup of coffee substituting that purchase for a less expensive but similar cup of coffee would create a savings between the price of preferred cup of coffee and the price from the less expensive cup of coffee. Those savings may be the product savings amount. Referring to FIG. 5, The desired product may be based on user input to computer system **101**, where the user can input from a personal device, such as personal computer **116**, tablet **181**, smartphone **171**, and smartwatch **191** their preferred product purchases for a merchant product module **1045A** in computer system **101** to compare to. In another embodiment, merchant product module **1045A** may monitor the historical spending behavior of the user to determine future merchant or product based savings amount. When a user makes a purchase through POS **162** or

another device capable of making a purchase in communication with computer system **101**, merchant product module **1045A** in computer system **101** may record the purchase amount and specific merchant and product, and accumulate historical spending amounts for types of products. Merchant product module **1045A** in computer system **101** may also determine if the user has saved money based on comparing expenditures from one time period to another from a particular merchant. For example, in one embodiment, merchant product module **1045A** could track monthly energy costs for heating or cooling a home to an energy company. Based on historical comparisons from previous months, merchant product module **1045** may determine a merchant based savings amount compared to the costs from that month in prior years.

(193) In another embodiment of the present disclosure, the user may enroll in a merchant or product blacklisting service. Merchant product module **1045A** in computer system **101** may blacklist particular merchants or products to force user savings by requiring less expensive alternatives. Computer system **101** may present the user with an option to enroll in merchant or product based savings in addition to other savings methods. If the user chooses to enroll in merchant or product based savings, merchant product module **1045A** may present the user with the option of entering desired products or merchants that it wishes to blacklist. If the user enters products or merchants it wants to block, merchant product module **1045A** may blacklist those products or merchants to keep the user from purchasing those particular products or all products from those blacklisted merchants from the user's source account. If the user does not select products or merchants it wishes to block, merchant product module **1045A** may track historical spending and periodically send blacklist notifications to the user suggesting products or merchants the user may wish to blacklist to increase savings. In another embodiment of the present disclosure, merchant product module **1045A** may track historical spending and the merchant or product SKU numbers. Merchant product module **1045A** may block certain merchants or products based on SKU numbers, or may send notifications for suggested products or merchants to block based on SKU numbers.

(194) FIG. **10** provides one embodiment of the merchant or product based savings method. In step **1000**, the debit to the source account (e.g., check card POS, check, and the like) is requested for authorization.

(195) In step **1016** and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. **5**, merchant product module **1045A** may determine if the product or merchant is blacklisted by the user. If the product of merchant is blacklisted, merchant product module **1045A** may proceed to cancel the debit transaction (step **1018**) and a \$0.00 transaction is created with a blacklist descriptor (step **1020**).

(196) In step **702**, the debit transaction, may be processed.

(197) In step **704**, the debit transaction may be posted to the source account.

(198) In step **1022** and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. **5**, merchant product module **1045A** may determine if the merchant or product SKU matches user records. Merchant product module **1045A** (via processor **103A**) may search memory **115A** of computer system **101** to attempt to match the SKU of the current purchase with the SKU of all previous debit transactions of the selected source account during enrollment in the merchant or product savings program.

Additionally, merchant product module **1045A** may also compare the current transaction with any selected products or merchants by the user at enrollment. If merchant product module **1045A** finds a match between the current transaction SKU and a previously selected or historical product or merchant SKU, the merchant and product module **1045A** then proceeds to step **1024**. If the current purchase does not match user records, then merchant and product module **1045A** proceeds to step **1028**.

(199) In step **1024** and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. **5**, where merchant product module **1045A** has found a SKU match between the current transaction and previous transactions or selections by the user, merchant product module **1045A** may determine if there is a merchant or product based savings by comparing the transaction amounts from the current transaction to the

previous matching SKU transactions. If merchant product module **1045A** determines that a merchant or product savings does exist, merchant product module **1045A** proceeds to step **1026** to calculate the savings. If merchant product module **1045A** determines that there are no merchant or product based savings, then merchant product module **1045A** proceeds to step **1030** to determine the savings method by another means.

(200) In step **1026** and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, merchant product module **1045A** may determine the savings amount based on a merchant or product comparable savings amount.

(201) In step **1028** and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, merchant product module **1045A** may determine if product or merchant based savings from comparable historic or selected products exist where no SKU match was found in the users records. Merchant product module **1045A** may run a matching algorithm to determine if there is a comparable product or service in the user's transaction history stored in memory **115A** from which product or merchant based savings methods may be determined based on identifying factors of the product or service that is the subject of the current transaction. If merchant product module **1045A** does find a comparable product or service, merchant product module **1045A** may determine there are product or merchant savings, and proceed to step **1026**. If merchant product module **1045A** determines there is no comparable product, or additionally no product or merchant savings, merchant product module **1045A** proceeds to step **1030**.

(202) In step **1030**, the method of calculating the savings amount may be determined for transactions where a product or merchant based method does not apply. In one embodiment, the savings amount may be determined by either a round up, a discount, a whole monetary amount, a percentage based, a "treat yourself" method, or other criterion.

(203) In step **1032** and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, merchant product module **1045A** may determine if the product or service that is the subject of the transaction should be recommended to the user for blacklisting. Merchant product module **1045A** may search memory **115A** to compare the product or service of the current transaction to historical comparable transactions by the user to determine if the user may be able to save with comparable products or services. If merchant product module **1045A** determines the user's savings would be enhanced by blacklisting product or service of the current transaction, the merchant product module **1045A** may proceed to step **1034**. If the merchant product module **1045A** determines the product or service should not be recommended, merchant product module **1045A** proceeds to step **708**.

(204) In step **1034** and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, merchant product module **1045A** may send a blacklist recommendation notification to the user. In one embodiment of the present disclosure, merchant product module **1045A** may send an encrypted blacklist recommendation notification via a modem in communications module **109A** through WAN **129** to the Internet **131**, and finally to smartphone **171**. Smartphone **171** receives the blacklist recommendation notification via internet **131** through communications module **109B** and stores the notification in memory **115B**. Merchant product module **1045B** in smartphone **171**, using processor **103B** then initiates presenting the blacklist recommendation notification via audio interface **222**. Audio interface **222** of smartphone **171** receives the notification from merchant product module **1045B**, and the audio interface may then convert the electrical notification into an audible signal to the user via speakers **224** of smartphone **171**. After receiving the audible blacklist recommendation notification, merchant product module **1045B** may then present selection input options for updating the user's product or merchant blacklist. Merchant product module **1045B** may present the selection input options for updating the user's product or merchant blacklist via touchscreen GUI **172** of communications module **109B** by processor **103B** of smartphone **171** to provide a graphical interface for the user to make a selection.

(205) In step **1038** and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, the product or merchant blacklist selection may be received. In one embodiment of the disclosure, smartphone **171** receives

the product or merchant blacklist selection from the user. Once the user selects the product or merchant blacklist selections by touching the corresponding product or merchant blacklist input options via touchscreen GUI **172**, that selection may be transmitted through communications module **109B** to merchant product module **1045B**, where it is then transmitted through communications module **109B** to merchant product module **1045A** of computer server **101** via the Internet **131** and communications module **109**. Upon receiving the product or merchant blacklist selection, merchant product module **1045A** may then update the blacklist in database **121A** in step **1016**.

(206) In step **708**, all merchant and product based savings, other default savings, or other amounts may be aggregated. This may occur on a daily, weekly, or other time basis. By aggregating the round ups for one daily or other selected time period for posting, exceeding account limits of the source account can be avoided. In one embodiment, the daily posting may occur at the end of the day to further avoid exceeding account limits.

(207) One of ordinary skill in the art after review of the present disclosure will appreciate that various features and aspects of the disclosure allow the user to receive blacklist recommendation notifications by other wireless devices besides smartphone **171**. The user may also associate other devices with the source account to communicate with merchant product module **1045A** in computer system **101** for receiving blacklist recommendation notification and for allowing the user to select blacklist updates, such as a user's personal computer **161**, tablet **181**, or smartwatch **191**. Any personal wireless device capable of containing merchant product module **1045B** or communicating with computer server **101** and merchant product module **1045A** may be used.

(208) Further, in another embodiment of the present disclosure and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, smartphone **171** may perform all of the steps outlined in FIG. 10 in the proceeding example without communicating with a computer server **101** or merchant product module **1045A**. In one example of such an embodiment, smartphone **171** may interact with a POS device **162** to try to purchase a cup of coffee at a café via a user's source account enrolled in the merchant or product based savings service. Upon attempting to purchase a cup of coffee, the POS **162** device at the café may communicate with merchant product module **1045B** of smartphone **171** via NFC for attempting to authorize the purchase. Merchant product module **1045B** may then identify the identity of the cup of coffee via a product SKU number stored in memory **115B**. Merchant product module **1045B** may then determine if the product SKU number is on a blacklist stored in memory **115B**, and if the product SKU is on a blacklist, merchant product module **1045B** may cancel the transaction and send a notification to the user alerting them to the cancelled transaction as being blacklisted. If the product SKU was determined to not be on a blacklist, merchant product module **1045B** may process the debit transaction and post the debit to the source account in communication with a bank server **141** or **151**. Then merchant product module **1045B** may determine the savings amount by determining if the product SKU matches user records for previous product or merchant based savings transactions. If merchant product module **1045B** finds a match of product SKU, it may determine a product based savings amount from previous savings amounts based on the monetary amount of a more expensive cup of coffee at another café. If there is no product based savings from the match of product SKUs, merchant product module **1045B** may then determine a savings amount based on a default method, such as a round up method described in previous examples. If there was no match in the user records for product SKU, merchant product module **1045B** may then search user records for other cups of coffee based on a matching algorithm to determine if any product savings method is available. If the merchant product module **1045B** finds a similar cup of coffee in the user records, and a product based savings amount applies, merchant product module **1045B** will apply that savings technique. If merchant product module **1045B** does not find a similar cup of coffee to apply a product based savings method, merchant product module **1045B** may proceed to apply the default savings method and determines a round up savings amount. Merchant product module **1045B** may also determine

that the user may wish to blacklist this particular product of merchant for the cup of coffee to increase savings, and therefore may send a graphical notification such as a text message to the user recommending that the user add this cup of coffee or café to the blacklist. Merchant product module **1045B** may also present the user with a graphical input to determine whether to blacklist the product or merchant. The merchant product module **1045B** may receive the user's input to blacklist the cup of coffee product, and may add that product SKU to a blacklist file in database **121**. Merchant product module **1045B** of smartphone **171** then proceeds to aggregate the savings amounts and to communicate with banking servers **141** or **151** for posting those savings.

(209) From the previous example of an embodiment of the present disclosure, it is clear that any personal mobile device capable of containing merchant product module **1045B** and communicating with a POS device such as POS **162**, may be able to carry out an embodiment of the present disclosure without need to communicate with a computer server **101** containing merchant product module **1045A**.

(210) In a further embodiment of the present disclosure, merchant product module **1045A** at computer server **101** or merchant product module **1045B** at smartphone **171** may communicate with a server **141** that contains a matching algorithm for determining if similar product purchases by a user are similar to the current transaction for providing product or merchant based savings. In a further example, merchant product module **1045B** of smartphone **171**, after failing to find a product or merchant SKU match in the user's previous transactions, communicates the SKU with server **141** via communications module **109B** through Internet **131**. Server **141** may then run the matching algorithm described in the previous example, and determine if there is a similar product based on the user's purchase history to match to the current transaction for determining a product based savings amount. Server **141** may then communicate this information to smartphone **171** for determining the savings amount. In this way, the matching algorithm may be stored on a separate server **141**, as opposed to smartphone **171** or other personal wireless device of the user.

(211) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, merchant product module **1045A** or **1045B** may recommend products to create product based savings after a purchase has occurred as described in the proceeding example. Upon a purchase by a user, merchant product module **1045B** may communicate with server **141** to run a matching algorithm to determine if there are matching products that merchant product module **1045B** in smartphone **171** may recommend to the user to switch to as a way to increase savings. If the matching algorithm at server **141** determines that a savings match is available, it may communicate that match to smartphone **171** as in the proceeding example.

(212) In a further embodiment of the present disclosure, a user may purchase a cup of coffee with smartphone **171**, and merchant product module **1045B** fails to find a product or merchant savings amount based on the user's purchase records in memory **115B** (step **1022**) and also fails to find a product or merchant savings amount based on a matching algorithm. Merchant product module **1045B** may then communicate with server **141** to instruct server **141** to run a matching algorithm to provide matches of similar products of cups of coffee that would save the user money if alternatively purchased. Upon finding a match, server **141** would communicate that example with merchant product module **1045B** of smartphone **171**, which would provide a graphical notification to the user as to the recommendation of the alternative cup of coffee to purchase to increase future savings.

(213) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, merchant product module **1045B** in smartphone **171** may identify a merchant or product identity at step **1016** based on a location device **104** in smartphone **171**. For example, upon entering a store, merchant product module **1045B** via location device **104** may detect the location of the smartphone as within a store and determine that store's merchant identity. Merchant product module **1045B** may then compare the location derived merchant identity to the blacklist (step **1016**), and may determine that attempts to authorize financial transactions for those merchant products within that location are blacklisted.

(214) In a further embodiment of the present disclosure, smartwatch **191** may receive blacklist recommendation notifications from merchant product module **1045A** in computer server **101** via communications module **109B**. Smartwatch **191** may not have merchant product module **1045B**, but upon receiving the blacklist recommendation notifications in communications module **109B**, directly present the notifications to the user via a graphical message on the smartwatch GUI in communications module **109B**, or as an audio alert through a speaker in communications module **109B** in smartwatch **191**. The smartwatch **191** may present any combination of graphical, audio, vibrational, or other method of blacklist recommendation notifications alerts to a user.

(215) Further, smartwatch **191** may allow for the user to make a blacklist recommendation selection at the smartwatch touchscreen GUI **172** and then communicate that selection to merchant product module **1045A** via communications module **109B** in smartwatch **191**, or it may communicate with another wireless device for the user to make a product or merchant blacklist selection. For example, upon receiving a blacklist recommendation selection from merchant product module **1045A**, smartwatch **191** may alert the user. Then, smartwatch **191** communicates the blacklist recommendation notification with another wireless device of the user, such as tablet **181**, which then presents the product or merchant blacklist selection input to the user.

(216) In accordance with various aspects of the disclosure, the blacklist recommendation notifications presented to the user may be communicated in various forms. For example, after the wireless device of the user receives the notification, it may present the notification via vibration of the wireless device. Merchant product module **1045B** of the wireless device, upon receiving the blacklist recommendation notification, would send the notification signal to a motor within communications module **109B** that activates the motor and causes vibration within the wireless device. In another example, the merchant product module **1045B** upon receiving blacklist recommendation notification would transmit a text or image graphical alert through a GUI of the communications module **109B**.

(217) Further, merchant product module **1045B** may receive the user input for selection of the savings goal update through additional means. For example, upon presenting the user with blacklist recommendation selections through a GUI in communications module **109B** of the wireless device, the user may select the blacklist recommendation through voice activation. Merchant product module **1045B** may transmit the blacklist recommendation information to the GUI via processor **103B** with corresponding voice activation phrases allowing a user to select blacklist recommendations, such as "blacklist product A". If the user speaks one of the voice activation phrases for an account, a microphone within the communications module **109B** may detect the phrase and then send that selection information to merchant product module **1045B**.

(218) In another example, the user may select a blacklist recommendation through a GUI in the wireless device via a keyboard or mouse in communications module **109B**.

(219) One of ordinary skill in the art after review of the present disclosure will appreciate that the user's mobile device may receive the blacklist recommendation through a number of means. For example, in one embodiment, merchant product module **1045B** of the wireless device may have the blacklist recommendation information stored on the mobile device in memory **115B**. In this embodiment, upon receiving the blacklist recommendation notification, merchant product module **1045B** of the wireless device would then retrieve the blacklist recommendation information from memory **115B** to present the blacklist recommendation selection input options to the user. In another embodiment, merchant product module **1045B** receives the blacklist recommendation information from computer server **101** along with the blacklist recommendation notification. The merchant product module **1045A** may encrypt the blacklist recommendation information and then transmit this information over the Internet **131** through communications module **109A** to the wireless device. Once the wireless device has received the encrypted blacklist recommendation information, merchant product module **1045B** then decrypts the information and sends this information to communication module **109B** for presenting to the user for selection. In a still

further embodiment, the wireless device may communicate directly with bank server **141** for receiving the blacklist recommendation information.

(220) In accordance with various aspects of the disclosure, merchant product module **1045A** as part of computer system **101** may exist within a bank server **141** or **151** of a financial institution, such that merchant product module **1045A** exists within memory **115A** of bank server **141** or **151**.

Blacklisting information may then be transmitted directly between bank server **141** or **151** to the user's wireless device. When merchant product module **1045A** in bank server **141** or **151** receives the blacklist information from the user's wireless device, merchant product module **1045A** through processor **103** then updates the blacklist information.

(221) Alternatively, the user's wireless device may not contain merchant product module **1045B** within memory **115B**. Merchant product module **1045A** may transmit and present blacklist recommendation notifications, as well as receive blacklist recommendation inputs from the user through the wireless device. Merchant product module **1045A** may communicate wirelessly with communications module **109B** in the wireless device to directly send blacklist recommendation notification signals to the user. Further, when the user makes a blacklist recommendation selection, that selection may be transmitted directly from communications module **109B** to the computers server **101** for processing by merchant product module **1045A**. In this sense, the user's wireless device is operating as a portal for presenting and receiving blacklist recommendation information from merchant product module **1045A** without requiring merchant product module **1045B** on the wireless device.

(222) In reference to FIG. **16**, in one embodiment of the present disclosure, the user is presented with an option to enroll in a frictionless savings service. If the user enrolls in the frictionless savings program, the user may select a source account (step **1600**), as well as a recipient account (step **1602**). In step **1604**, the user may enter user information requested by computer server **101**, which can include the user's income and expenditures, family information, and personal information of the user, such as age, health, and education, among any other relative criterion for helping to determine the most appropriate methods for savings. The user may then enter a savings goal for the recipient account (**1612**), and a time period for achieving the savings goal (step **1614**). The user may then select a savings method (step **1608**). Additionally, the frictionless savings module **1146A** as disclosed in FIG. **5**, may instead select appropriate savings methods for achieving the user's savings goal within the proposed time frame without the user selecting a savings method. The user is then presented with terms and conditions for the frictionless savings program and finalizes the enrollment (step **1610**). The frictionless savings module **1146A** may also track the spending and savings of the user over time, and automatically adjust or change the savings methods to keep the user's total savings on track to meet their selected goal. Frictionless savings module **1146A** may also track the user's funds available in the source account, and automatically adjust the savings method to maintain a sufficient level of funds in the source account, or adjust the savings method to increase the savings rate based on the funds in the source account. The sufficient fund level may be determined automatically by the frictionless savings module **1146A** based on the user's additional information and the server's records of historical expenditure levels and funds in the source account. Additionally, if the funds in the source account are above recorded fund levels, frictionless savings module **1146A** can adjust the savings method to increase savings.

(223) In another embodiment of the present disclosure, the frictionless savings module **1146A** may further notify the user when the user's savings goal has been accomplished. Frictionless savings module **1146A** may send a notification via Internet **131** to the users selected wireless device for receiving updates, such as personal computer **161**, tablet **181**, smartphone **171**, and smartwatch **181**, among any other wireless device able to associate with frictionless savings module **1146A**.

(224) FIG. **11** shows an embodiment of the frictionless savings method of the present disclosure. In step **700**, a debit to a source account (e.g., check card POS, check, and the like) is authorized.

(225) In step **702**, the debit transaction, such as a purchase at POS **162** using a debit card, may be

processed.

(226) In step **704**, the debit transaction may be posted to the source account.

(227) In step **800**, the daily posting transaction begins.

(228) In step **710**, a determination may be made if funds are available in the source account. If not, the aggregated round up debit transaction may be cancelled (step **718**) and a \$0.00 transaction is created with a no funds in source account descriptor (step **720**).

(229) In step **1100**, a determination may be made if the user has reached their savings goal. The frictionless savings module **1146A** determines the total savings of the user and compares this to the savings goal of the user. If the savings have reached the user's savings goal, frictionless savings module **1146A** cancels the aggregated savings transaction (step **1102**) and sends a completion notification to the user (step **1104**).

(230) In step **1104**, frictionless savings module **1146A** may send a completion notification to the user. In one embodiment of the present disclosure, frictionless savings module **1146A** may send a completion notification via a modem in communications module **109A** through WAN **129** to the Internet **131**, and finally to smartphone **171**. Smartphone **171** receives the completion notification via internet **131** through communications module **109B**. Frictionless savings module **1146B** in smartphone **171**, using processor **103B** then initiates presenting the completion notification via audio interface **222**. Audio interface **222** of smartphone **171** receives the notification from frictionless savings module **1146B**, and the audio interface may then convert the electrical notification into an audible signal to the user via speakers **224** of smartphone **171**.

(231) In step **1106**, frictionless savings module **1146A** may determine if the user's savings amounts are on track to meet the user's savings goal. If frictionless savings module **1146A** determines that the user's savings are on track, frictionless savings module **1146A** proceeds to step **1110**. If the user's savings are determined to not be on track, then frictionless savings module **1146A** proceeds to step **1108**.

(232) In step **1108**, frictionless savings module **1146A** determines an alternative savings method to use as the default savings method for transactions to meet the user defined goal.

(233) In step **1110**, frictionless savings module **1146A** maintains the default savings method.

(234) In step **708**, all round up or other amounts may be aggregated. This may occur on a daily, weekly, or other time basis. By aggregating the round ups for one daily or other selected time period for posting, exceeding account limits of the source account can be avoided. In one embodiment, the daily posting may occur at the end of the day to further avoid exceeding account limits.

(235) Additionally, alternative embodiments of the present disclosure may determine that the user's savings as of the determination in step **1106** are on track by a number of methods. In one embodiment, frictionless savings module **1146A** may calculate the aggregate savings over a set time period, such as a week, month, or other time period, and determine if the savings during that time period meet a certain percentage of the savings goal correlating to the percentage of time to the savings goal. In another embodiment, frictionless savings module **1146A** may determine if the user's savings are on track based on the percentage of savings relative to available funds.

(236) In accordance with various aspects of the disclosure and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, the frictionless savings module **1146A** may determine alternative savings methods to increase savings at step **1108** in a number of ways. In one embodiment, frictionless savings module **1146A** determines the alternative savings method based on the average available funds in the source account during the tracked goal period as determined in step **1106**. In another embodiment, frictionless savings module **1146A** may determine the savings method based on the savings method that will complete the savings goal closest to a given time period selected by the user.

(237) Additionally, frictionless savings module **1146A** may determine an alternative savings method at step **1108** from a number of methods. Frictionless savings module **1146A** may adopt a round up, whole monetary, percentage based, product or merchant based, discount based, or other

alternative savings methods to reach the desired goal.

(238) One of ordinary skill in the art after review of the present disclosure will appreciate that various features and aspects of the disclosure allow the user to receive completion notifications by other wireless devices besides smartphone **171**. The user may also associate other devices with the source account to communicate with frictionless savings module **1146A** in computer system **101** for receiving completion notifications and for allowing the user to select blacklist updates, such as a user's personal computer **161**, tablet **181**, or smartwatch **191**. Any personal wireless device capable of communicating with computer server **101** and frictionless savings module **1146A** may be used.

(239) In a further embodiment of the present disclosure, smartwatch **191** may receive completion notifications from frictionless savings module **1146A** in computer server **101** via communications module **109B**. Smartwatch **191** may not have frictionless savings module **1146A**, but upon receiving the completion notifications in communications module **109B**, directly present the notifications to the user via a graphical message on the smartwatch GUI in communications module **109B**, or as an audio alert through a speaker in communications module **109B** in smartwatch **191**. The smartwatch **191** may present any combination of graphical, audio, vibrational, or other method of completion notifications alerts to a user.

(240) In accordance with various aspects of the disclosure, the completion notifications presented to the user may be communicated in various forms. For example, after the wireless device of the user receives the notification, it may present the notification via vibration of the wireless device. Frictionless savings module **1146B** of the wireless device, upon receiving the completion notifications, would send the notification signal to a motor within communications module **109B** that activates the motor and causes vibration within the wireless device. In another example, the frictionless savings module **1146B** upon receiving completion notifications would transmit a text or image graphical alert through a GUI of the communications module **109B**.

(241) One of ordinary skill in the art after review of the present disclosure will appreciate that the user's mobile device may receive the completion notifications through a number of means. For example, in one embodiment, frictionless savings module **1146B** of the wireless device may have the completion notification information stored on the mobile device in memory **115B**. In this embodiment, upon receiving the completion notification, frictionless savings module **1146B** of the wireless device would then retrieve the completion notification information from memory **115B** to present the completion notification to the user. In another embodiment, frictionless savings module **1146B** receives the completion notifications from computer server **101**. The frictionless savings module **1146A** may transmit the completion notifications information over Internet **131** through communications module **109A** to the wireless device. Once the wireless device has received the completion notifications, frictionless savings module **1146B** then sends this information to communication module **109B** for presenting to the user for selection. In a still further embodiment, the wireless device may communicate directly with bank server **141** for receiving the blacklist recommendation information.

(242) In accordance with various aspects of the disclosure, frictionless savings module **1146A** as part of computer system **101** may exist within a bank server **141** or **151** of a financial institution, such that frictionless savings module **1146A** exists within memory **115A** of bank server **141** or **151**. Blacklisting information may then be transmitted directly between bank server **141** or **151** to the user's wireless device. When frictionless savings module **1146A** in bank server **141** or **151** receives the completion notification from the user's wireless device, frictionless savings module **1146A** through processor **103** then updates the blacklist information.

(243) Alternatively, the user's wireless device may not contain frictionless savings module **1146B** within memory **115B**. Frictionless savings module **1146A** may transmit and present blacklist recommendation notifications, as well as receive blacklist recommendation inputs from the user through the wireless device. Frictionless savings module **1146A** may communicate wirelessly with

communications module **109B** in the wireless device to directly send blacklist recommendation notification signals to the user. Further, when the user makes a blacklist recommendation selection, that selection may be transmitted directly from communications module **109B** to the computers server **101** for processing by frictionless savings module **1146A**. In this sense, the user's wireless device is operating as a portal for presenting and receiving blacklist recommendation information from frictionless savings module **1146A** without requiring frictionless savings module **1146B** on the wireless device.

(244) In an additional embodiment of the present disclosure, frictionless savings module **1146A** may determine a savings method using comparisons to savings rates for demographically similar users. For example, frictionless savings module **1146A** in computer server **101** may communicate with frictionless savings module **1146B** of bank servers **151** via communications modules **109A** and **109B** through Internet **131** to compare the user's saving rate to demographically similar user based on their information saved in memory **115B** of computer servers **151**. Bank servers **151** may determine demographically similar user based on the goals and information entered when the users enrolled in the frictionless savings program. Upon determining demographically similar users, bank servers **151** may send the demographically similar user savings rate information to frictionless savings module **1146A** of computer server **101**, which will then incorporate the demographically similar savings rate into calculating a frictionless savings amount.

(245) Further, frictionless savings module **1146A** may communicate with servers **141** representing social media servers, to determine a savings method using comparisons to savings rates for demographically similar users. For example, a user may be enrolled in social media applications and link his frictionless savings account to his social media applications. Frictionless savings module **1146A** in computer server **101** may communicate with those social media application servers **141** to determine demographically similar users according to the proceeding example. Frictionless savings module **1146A** may then incorporate those demographically similar user's savings rates in calculating a frictionless savings amount.

(246) Further, in another embodiment of the present disclosure, the user may enroll in the frictionless savings program and connect the frictionless savings program to a social media application for the purpose of comparing savings rates with those of friends who are also enrolled in the frictionless savings program and the social media application.

(247) In one embodiment of the present disclosure, the user may enroll in a savings and investment program. A user may select recipient investment account for their savings, and select an associated investment portfolio with the investment account from which the savings will be invested into.

(248) FIG. **6B** is a flow diagram of the functionality performed by computer system **101** in accordance with one embodiment of the present disclosure in order to enroll a user in the savings and investment program.

(249) In step **602**, account set-up and maintenance screens/interfaces are accessed in response to a user request to enroll in the automatic savings program. In one embodiment, the screens/interfaces are accessed by bank personnel at a terminal locally or remotely connected to computer system **101**. In another embodiment, a user may access the screens/interfaces at a terminal remotely connected to computer system **101** through Internet **131**. In another embodiment, the user may access the screens/interfaces with any wireless device capable of connecting to the computer system **101** through Internet **131**, such as ATM **163**, personal computer **161**, tablet **181**, smartphone **171**, or smartwatch **191**.

(250) In step **604**, the checking account that is the source of the automatic savings amount is selected. The eligible source accounts are displayed from the user's profile. In other embodiments, another type of account instead of a checking account can be used, as long as the selected account is a source of funds.

(251) In step **606**, the savings method is selected. One method may be a "round up," which refers to one method used to calculate a savings amount from a transaction. In one embodiment, the round

up amount is an amount of excess funds produced by applying a rounder transaction to the amount of a transaction such as a credit/debit card charge at POS **162**. If the rounder transaction rounds up to the nearest dollar, for example, a purchase made for \$54.08 would generate a rounded amount of \$0.92. Other embodiments of the present disclosure may round up to a predetermined amount besides the nearest dollar. Still further, other embodiments of the present disclosure may calculate the savings amount using a method other than round up. For example, a fixed percentage can be applied to each transaction to calculate a savings amount, or a fixed amount of money (e.g., \$1.20) can be considered the savings amount. The available debits/transaction types to be round up are displayed (step **607**) and can include check card/debit card POS transactions, or any other types of debits. Examples of other debits that can be the subject of round up or other calculation of a savings amount include paper checks, electronic bill pay, electronic checks, automatic payments and Automated Clearing House (“ACH”) transfers.

(252) In step **616**, the recipient investment account or accounts for the savings amount may be selected based on the displayed eligible recipient accounts and preference option fields for the accounts can be inputted. In one embodiment, possible recipient accounts include the user's own recipient investment account, person-to-person transfer (e.g., a grandparent's round ups being credited to a grandchild's recipient investment account), and the like. In general, any recipient investment account that can accept transfers can be eligible for selection. If multiple recipient investment accounts are selected, the user can choose a percentage distribution for each of the recipient accounts, or another mechanism that can be used to divide the savings amount between the multiple investment accounts or create a preference for savings between the accounts.

(253) In step **610**, goals may be selected for the recipient investment account or accounts. In one embodiment, the server may present the user with an option to input the user's desired financial goals. To determine the user's desired financial goals, the server may request information from the user regarding the user's qualitative or quantitative goals, such as “buy a car,” “pay for child's college education” or “save \$2,000.” The server can additionally request a time frame to achieve this goal, and may also request the user's income and expenditures, and any additional information that may be relevant to ascertaining the appropriate savings method for the user. A separate goal can be selected for each recipient investment account if multiple recipient investment accounts are selected for the program. The user may also select intermediate goals for a recipient investment account to help the user stay on track for reaching their goal for the recipient investment account.

(254) In step **618**, the user may select an investment portfolio to associate with the recipient investment account for the savings to be applied to. The savings amounts that are directed into the investment account may then be invested into the selected investment portfolio. The user may select multiple investment accounts, and split up the round up amounts between the multiple selected investment accounts. Each individual investment account may be associated with a separate investment portfolio. In another embodiment of the disclosure, the investment portfolio may be pre-defined, in which the investments of the portfolio have been pre-selected by another individual. For example, the investment portfolio may be designed by an investment manager at the bank of the investment account, or another third party that provides the portfolio to the bank.

(255) In step **612**, notification services may be selected for the savings accounts.

(256) In step **614**, user disclosures may be presented to the user to agree to before enrollment.

(257) Referring to FIG. **18**, enrolling a user in a savings and investment program through a GUI is shown. GUI **1800** shows an interface presented to a user with selectable inputs **1822** for selecting a portfolio. Element **1816** shows display elements for the portfolio risk levels and the performance levels of each portfolio. The user may select element **1804** for entering in financial goals for the recipient account. Element **1818** of the GUI **1800** shows a display element for the growth projection of each portfolio.

(258) In a further embodiment of the present disclosure, once a user has identified the investment account where the round up investments will go, the user may select a pre-defined investment

portfolio from a number of portfolio options presented to the user, and the user chooses a preferred investment portfolio based on the risk levels respectively indicated for the portfolio options. A pre-defined portfolio may be designed based on an overall risk level for the portfolio, e.g., as determined by an investment manager. In one embodiment, an investment portfolio may be defined as “low risk,” “medium risk,” or “high risk.” A “low risk” portfolio may be characterized by having a relatively low rate of return but also a relatively low risk of loss as compared to “medium risk” or “high risk” portfolios. A “medium risk” portfolio may be characterized by having a relatively higher rate of return and a relatively higher risk of loss as compared to a “low risk” portfolio, but also by having a relatively lower rate of return and a relatively lower risk of loss as compared to a “high risk” portfolio. A “high risk” portfolio may be characterized by having a relatively higher rate of return and a relatively higher risk of loss as compared to both a “low risk” portfolio and a “medium risk” portfolio. As an example, a pre-defined investment portfolio may be designated as “low risk” by having an estimated rate of return of 3% and a relatively low corresponding risk of loss, while a “medium risk” portfolio may have estimated rate of return of 6%, and a relatively medium corresponding risk of loss, and a “high risk” portfolio may have estimated rate of return of 10% with a relatively high corresponding risk of loss. Still further, other embodiments of the present application may include rates of return and risks of loss that vary over time with risk designations, for example, in response to changes in inflation rates. Additionally, there may be more varied levels of risk of portfolios to accommodate a greater variety of user preferences.

(259) Additionally, after obtaining the information requested from the user regarding their goals for the investment account, computer server **101** may recommend a pre-defined investment portfolio based on the user's information. Computer server **101** may additionally recommend multiple pre-defined portfolios based on the selection of investment savings methods, which may adjust the time to reach the user's savings goal. Also, computer server **101** may present an estimate as to when any of the recommended pre-defined investment portfolios would meet the user's savings goal, and also present the growth projection based on the performance of the pre-defined investment portfolio. In another embodiment, the server may allow the user to configure the investment portfolios to meet their specific needs, by allowing the user to combine or edit investment portfolios. For example, a user may wish to combine two investment portfolios into one to create a custom risk and reward expectation. Still further, in another embodiment a user may wish to edit a single portfolio to create a safer or riskier portfolio than is available. Once a user has configured the pre-defined investment portfolios to meet the users customized needs, the server may analyzed this new customized portfolio and provide the user with information regarding the estimated rate of return and risk of losses, growth projections, and time estimates to meet the user's goals.

(260) In another embodiment, the savings amount may be determined by a discount method. Many retailers and companies provide discounts on goods or services based on user membership or in coordination with the user's financial institution. When a user makes a purchase from their source account, and is provided a discount by the provider of goods or services in affiliation with the bank of the source account, the computer system **101**, in communication with the retailer/provider, determines the difference between the discounted amount and the full price. This is the discount amount. The user is then charged the full price, with the discount amount then being applied to the recipient account from the source account as a savings amount. An example of this embodiment is a purchase made by a user at a grocery store. In affiliation with a bank, a grocery store chain may provide discounts for members of the bank who make purchases at the grocery store with their bank cards. A user who is enrolled in the program may pay the “full price,” but the discount amount is actually being saved into the recipient investment account from the user's source account.

(261) FIG. **12** displays one embodiment of the discount savings method. In step **700**, a debit to a source account (e.g., check card POS, check, and the like) is authorized.

(262) In step **702**, the debit transaction is processed.

(263) In step **704**, the debit transaction may be posted to the source account.

(264) In step **800**, the daily posting transaction begins.

(265) In step **1200**, and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, discount savings module **1238A** in computer system **101** may determine if the debit transaction was a discounted transaction. Discount savings module **1238A** may communicate with POS device **162** via communication module **109A** through Internet **131** to determine if a savings discount was applied to the transaction.

(266) In step **1202**, and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, discount savings module **1238A** may determine the discount amount associated with the transaction. Discount savings module **1238A** may communicate with POS device **162** via communication module **109A** through Internet **131** to determine the savings discount amount. Discount savings module **1238A** then stores that discount amount in memory **115A**.

(267) In step **1204**, discount savings module **1238A** compares whether the discount savings amount is greater than the default savings method.

(268) In step **1206**, and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, the savings amount may be determined by the default savings method. In one embodiment, this method may be a non-discount savings method that discount savings module **1238A** applies where there were no discounts in the transaction, or where a discount savings method may provide fewer saving than the default method. Further, the default savings amount may be determined by either a round up, a discount, a merchant or product based savings, a whole monetary amount, a percentage based, a “treat yourself” method, or other criterion. The default method may be selected by the user during enrollment in the discount savings method.

(269) In step **708**, all discount or default savings amounts, or other amounts, may be aggregated. This may occur on a daily basis. By aggregating the round ups for one daily posting, exceeding account limits the source account can be avoided. In one embodiment, the daily posting may occur at the end of the day to further avoid exceeding account limits.

(270) In step **1208**, and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, discount savings module **1238A** may determine if a merchant discount affiliation option is available to the user to increase future savings. In one embodiment of the present invention, discount savings module **1238A** via communication module **109A** through Internet **131** may communicate with a computer server **141** that is affiliated with the merchant associated with the transaction at step **700** of FIG. **12**. Discount savings module **1238A** may request information regarding any possible membership or affiliation discounts that the user may enroll in with the merchant or retailer associated with the transaction that may increase future savings.

(271) In step **1210**, and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, discount savings module **1238A** may send a discount affiliation notification to the user. In one embodiment of the present disclosure, discount savings module **1238A** may send a discount affiliation notification via a modem in communications module **109A** through WAN **129** to the Internet **131**, and finally to smartphone **171**. Smartphone **171** receives the discount affiliation notification via Internet **131** through communications module **109B** and stores the notification in memory **115B**. Discount savings module **1238B** in smartphone **171**, using processor **103B** then initiates presenting the discount affiliation notification via audio interface **222**. Audio interface **222** of smartphone **171** receives the notification from discount savings module **1238B**, and the audio interface may then converts the electrical notification into an audible signal to the user via speakers **224** of smartphone **171**. After receiving the audible discount affiliation notification, discount savings module **1238B** may then present discount affiliation information and selection input options for creating the user's merchant affiliation or membership. Discount savings module **1238B** may present the selection input options for creating the user's merchant affiliation or membership via touchscreen GUI **172** of communications module **109B** by processor **103B** of smartphone **171** to provide a graphical interface for the user to make a selection.

(272) In step **1212**, and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. 5, the discount affiliation

selection may be received. In one embodiment of the disclosure, smartphone **171** receives the discount affiliation selection from the user. Once the user selects the discount affiliation selections by touching the corresponding discount affiliation input options via touchscreen GUI **172**, that selection may be transmitted through communications module **109B** to discount savings module **1238B**, where it is then transmitted through communications module **109B** to discount savings module **1238A** of computer server **101** via the Internet **131** and communications module **109**. Upon receiving the discount affiliation selection, discount savings module **1238A** may then communicate with a computer server **141** that is affiliated with discount affiliation for creating the user's membership or affiliation.

(273) In step **710**, a determination may be made if funds are available in the source account. If not, the aggregated round up debit transaction may be cancelled (step **718**) and a \$0.00 transaction is created with a no funds in source account descriptor (step **720**).

(274) One of ordinary skill in the art after review of the present disclosure will appreciate that various features and aspects of the disclosure allow the user to receive discount affiliation notifications by other wireless devices besides smartphone **171**. The user may also associate other devices with the source account to communicate with discount savings module **1238A** in computer system **101** for receiving discount affiliation notifications and for allowing the user to select discount affiliations, such as a user's personal computer **161**, tablet **181**, or smartwatch **191**. Any personal wireless device capable of containing discount savings module **1238B** or communicating with computer server **101** and discount savings module **1238A** may be used.

(275) Further, in another embodiment of the present disclosure, smartphone **171** may perform all of the steps outlined in FIG. **12** in the proceeding example without communicating with a computer server **101** or discount savings module **1238A**. In one example of such an embodiment, smartphone **171** may interact with a POS device **162** to try to purchase a cup of coffee at a café via a user's source account enrolled in the discount savings service. Upon attempting to purchase a cup of coffee, the POS **162** device at the café may communicate with discount savings module **1238B** of smartphone **171** via NFC for authorizing the purchase. Discount savings module **1238B** may then determine if a discount was applied to the cup of coffee via a membership affiliation between the user and the merchant. If a discount was not applied, discount savings module **1238B** may then communicate with computer server **141** affiliated with the merchant to determine if a membership or affiliation discount exists, and if such a membership exists, discount savings module **1238B** may send a notification to the user alerting them to a membership or affiliation savings. Discount savings module **1238B** may send a graphical notification such as a text message to the user recommending that the user may enroll in a membership of affiliation with the merchant. Discount savings module **1238B** may also present the user with a graphical input to determine whether to enroll in a membership with the merchant. The discount savings module **1238B** may receive the user's input to enroll in the membership. Discount savings module **1238B** then communicates with computer server **141** affiliated with the merchant to update the user's enrollment. If there is no discount based savings from a membership of affiliation, discount savings module **1238B** may then determine a savings amount based on a default method, such as a round up method described in previous examples. Discount savings module **1238B** of smartphone **171** then proceeds to aggregate the savings amounts and to communicate with banking servers **141** or **151** for posting those savings to the recipient investment account.

(276) From the previous example of an embodiment of the present disclosure, it is clear that any personal mobile device capable of containing discount savings module **1238B** and communicating with a POS **162** or computer system **141** may be able to carry out an embodiment of the present disclosure without need to communicate with a computer server **101** containing discount savings module **1238A**.

(277) In one embodiment of the present disclosure and with reference to elements depicted in FIG. **5**, discount savings module **1238B** in smartphone **171** may identify a merchant identity to enroll in

a membership or affiliation at step **1208** based on a location device **104** in smartphone **171**. For example, upon entering a store, discount savings module **1238B** via location device **104** may detect the location of the smartphone as within a store and determine that store's merchant identity. Discount savings module **1238B** may determine if there is a membership or affiliation available for the user to enroll in to increase savings (step **1208**), and may send a discount affiliation notification to the user.

(278) In a further embodiment of the present disclosure, smartwatch **191** may receive discount affiliation notification from discount savings module **1238A** in computer server **101** via communications module **109B**. Smartwatch **191** may not have discount savings module **1238B**, but upon receiving the discount affiliation notification in communications module **109B**, directly present the notifications to the user via a graphical message on the smartwatch GUI in communications module **109B**, or as an audio alert through a speaker in communications module **109B** in smartwatch **191**. The smartwatch **191** may present any combination of graphical, audio, vibrational, or other method of discount affiliation notification alerts to a user.

(279) Further, smartwatch **191** may allow for the user to make a discount affiliation selection at the smartwatch touchscreen GUI **172** and then communicate that selection to discount savings module **1238A** via communications module **109B** in smartwatch **191**, or it may communicate with another wireless device for the user to make a discount affiliation selection. For example, upon receiving a discount affiliation selection from discount savings module **1238B**, smartwatch **191** may alert the user. Then, smartwatch **191** communicates the discount affiliation notification with another wireless device of the user, such as tablet **181**, which then presents the product or merchant discount affiliation selection input to the user.

(280) In accordance with various aspects of the disclosure, the discount affiliation notifications presented to the user may be communicated in various forms. For example, after the wireless device of the user receives the notification, it may present the notification via vibration of the wireless device. Discount savings module **1238B** of the wireless device, upon receiving the discount affiliation notification, would send the notification signal to a motor within communications module **109B** that activates the motor and causes vibration within the wireless device. In another example, the discount savings module **1238B** upon receiving discount affiliation notification would transmit a text or image graphical alert through a GUI of the communications module **109B**.

(281) Further, discount savings module **1238B** may receive the user input for selection of the discount affiliation enrollment through additional means. For example, upon presenting the user with discount affiliation selections through a GUI in communications module **109B** of the wireless device, the user may select the discount affiliation through voice activation. Discount savings module **1238B** may transmit the discount affiliation information to the GUI via processor **103B** with corresponding voice activation phrases allowing a user to select discount affiliations, such as "enroll in membership A". If the user speaks one of the voice activation phrases for an account, a microphone within the communications module **109B** may detect the phrase and then send that selection information to discount savings module **1238B**.

(282) In another example, the user may select a discount affiliation notification through a GUI in the wireless device via a keyboard or mouse in communications module **109B**.

(283) One of ordinary skill in the art after review of the entirety disclosed herein will appreciate that the user's mobile device may receive the discount affiliation notification through a number of means. In one embodiment, discount savings module **1238B** of the mobile device receives the discount affiliation notification information from computer server **101** along with the discount affiliation notification. The discount savings module **1238B** may transmit this information over the Internet **131** through communications module **109A** to the wireless device. Once the wireless device has received the discount affiliation notification, discount savings module **1238B** then sends this information to communication module **109B** for presenting to the user for selection. In a still

further embodiment, discount savings module **1238B** of the mobile device may communicate directly with merchant server **141** for receiving the discount affiliation notification without communicating with computer server **101**.

(284) Alternatively, the user's wireless device may not contain discount savings module **1238B** within memory **115B**. Discount savings module **1238A** may transmit and present discount affiliation notifications, as well as receive discount affiliation inputs from the user through the wireless device. Discount savings module **1238A** may communicate wirelessly with communications module **109B** in the wireless device to directly send discount affiliation notification signals to the user. Further, when the user makes discount affiliation selection, that selection may be transmitted directly from communications module **109B** to the computers server **101** for processing by discount savings module **1238A**. In this sense, the user's wireless device is operating as a portal for presenting and receiving discount affiliation information from discount savings module **1238A** without requiring discount savings module **1238B** on the wireless device.

(285) Another embodiment of the disclosure includes forms of computer-readable media. Computer-readable media include any available media that can be accessed by a computing device **101**. Computer-readable media may comprise non-transitory storage media and communication media. Non-transitory storage media include volatile and nonvolatile, removable and non-removable media implemented in any method or technology for storage of information such as computer-readable instructions, object code, data structures, program modules, or other data. (286) Although not required, one of ordinary skill in the art after review of the present disclosure will appreciate that various aspects described herein may be embodied as a method, a data processing system, or as a computer-readable medium storing computer-executable instructions. For example, a computer-readable medium storing instructions to cause a processor to perform steps of a method in accordance with aspects of the disclosure is contemplated. For example, aspects of the method steps disclosed herein may be executed on a processor on a computing device **101**. Such a processor may execute computer-executable instructions stored on a computer-readable medium.

(287) Aspects of the disclosure have been described in terms of illustrative embodiments thereof. Numerous other embodiments, modifications and variations within the scope and spirit of the appended claims will occur to persons of ordinary skill in the art from a review of this disclosure. For example, one of ordinary skill in the art after review of the entirety disclosed herein will appreciate that the steps illustrated in the illustrative figures may be performed in other than the recited order, and that one or more steps illustrated may be optional in accordance with aspects of the disclosure. Also, one of ordinary skill in the art after review of the entirety disclosed herein will appreciate that various features and aspects of the disclosure may be combined with other features and aspects disclosed herein.

(288) For example, one of ordinary skill in the art after review of the present disclosure will appreciate that a user may select to enroll in multiple savings methods. For example, a user may decide to enroll in both the product/merchant based savings method and also the discount method. In this embodiment, during a financial transaction at a retail location, computer sever **101** may communicate with a POS device **162** at the retail location to determine if product or merchant based savings exist, and additionally if a discount savings exist. Merchant product module **1045A** may determine that a merchant or product based savings exists. Additionally, discount savings module **1238A** may also determine that a discount savings exists. The merchant product module **1045A** and discount savings module **1238A** in computer server **101** may communicate to determine which of the savings methods provides greater savings for the user, and send a notification to user via the user's smartphone **171**. In a further embodiment, merchant product module **1045A** and discount savings module **1238A** may communicate to determine if discount savings may apply in conjunction with product or merchant savings to create greater savings than only applying a product or merchant based savings method alone.

(289) In another example that one of ordinary skill in the art after review of the present disclosure will appreciate, a user may select to enroll in multiple notifications as well as multiple savings methods. For example, a user may select to enroll in a selective distribution service as well as an additional savings service. In this example, selective distribution module **1242A** in computer system **101** may determine that savings have met a threshold for sending a selective distribution notification to the user at smartphone **171**. In addition, additional savings module **843A** may also determine that the user is not on track for their savings goal, and may send an additional savings notification in conjunction with the selective distribution notification, prompting a user to add additional savings to the selective distribution amount. In a still further embodiment, the user may also be enrolled in the savings goal module, such that the user is also sent periodic savings goal notifications from savings goal module **944A**, in addition to receiving selective distribution notifications and additional savings notifications from selective distribution module **1242A** and additional savings module **843A**, respectively.

(290) In another example that one of ordinary skill in the art after review of the present disclosure will appreciate, particular embodiments and technology from a savings method described may be combined with particular embodiments and technology from a different savings method. For example, a user may be enrolled in a merchant and product savings service, and the savings goal service. The user's transactions from their enrolled source account would be monitored by merchant product module **1045A** for any merchant or product based savings, and the user may also receive periodic savings goal notifications from savings goal module **944A**. Still further, the user may also connect their source account with social media applications used by the user, such that savings goal module **944A** may communicate with frictionless savings module **1146A** of computer **101** and frictionless savings module **1146B** of bank servers **151** via communications modules **109A** and **109B** through Internet **131** to compare the user's saving rate to demographically similar user based on their information saved in memory **115B** of computer servers **151**. In this way, when the user receives periodic savings goal notifications from savings goal module **944A**, the notifications may also include a comparison of saving rates from demographically similar users who are connected to the user via social media applications.

(291) Also, one of ordinary skill in the art after review of the present disclosure will appreciate that various features and aspects of the disclosure may be combined with other features and aspects disclosed herein. For example, various aspects of the numerous examples provided with regards to debit card use may be applied to embodiments regarding credit card use. Likewise the different matching/bonus features listed herein may be combined or substituted for other matching/bonus features to fully appreciate the embodiments contemplated by the entirety of the disclosure. Additionally, different saving/notification features may be combined or substituted for other savings/notification features to fully appreciate the embodiments contemplated by the entirety of the disclosure.

Claims

1. A method to reduce computing load on a point-of-sale device, the method comprising: authorizing, by a computer server in signal communication with the point-of-sale device, a first financial transaction initiated at the point-of-sale device; posting, by the computer server, the first financial transaction to a source account; calculating, by the computer server, a first savings amount by rounding a transaction amount of the first financial transaction to a nearest whole monetary amount, wherein the first savings amount is a difference between the transaction amount and the nearest whole monetary amount; determining, by the computer server, an aggregate savings amount by adding together the first savings amount and a second savings amount calculated for a second financial transaction posted to the source account; determining, by the computer server, that the aggregate savings amount is available in the source account before debiting the aggregate

savings amount from the source account; determining, by the computer server, that the aggregate savings amount has reached a pre-determined threshold; sending, by the computer server, a notification to a mobile device associated with the source account that the aggregate savings amount has reached the pre-determined threshold, wherein the notification comprises a signal activating a motor in the mobile device to cause vibration of the mobile device, and wherein computing load on the point-of-sale device is reduced by deferring calculation of the first savings amount to the computer server, and wherein computing load on the computer server is reduced by postponing a step of debiting at least a portion of the aggregate savings amount from the source account until the aggregate savings amount has reached the pre-determined threshold; receiving, by the computer server from the mobile device, a selective distribution message type, wherein the selective distribution message type comprises selection information, wherein the selection information identifies one or more recipient accounts selected through an interface of the mobile device; and separating then distributing, by the computer server, the selective distribution message type into a plurality of messages to a plurality of banking servers to cause the plurality of banking servers to debit at least a portion of the aggregate savings amount from the source account to the one or more recipient accounts, wherein the separating then distributing of the plurality of messages distributes a processing load among the plurality of banking servers.

2. The method of claim 1, wherein the notification is a selective distribution message type, the selective distribution message type being a unique packet containing fields relating to message identification, source accounts, recipient accounts, savings amounts, dates, and savings selections.

3. The method of claim 1, further including encrypting the selection information before transmitting over a network.

4. The method of claim 1, wherein the mobile device is a smartphone.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein the notification comprises a text message to the mobile device.

6. The method of claim 1, wherein the pre-determined threshold is a fixed amount of funds.

7. The method of claim 1, wherein the pre-determined threshold is a percentage of funds of a goal selected by a user.

8. The method of claim 1, wherein the pre-determined threshold is aggregate savings over a given time period.

9. The method of claim 1, wherein the interface is a touchscreen display.

10. The method of claim 9, wherein the touchscreen display includes touchscreen elements identifying recipient accounts.

11. A system to reduce computing load on a point-of-sale device, the system comprising: the point of sale device configured to conduct a financial transaction; a computer server, configured to communicate with the point of sale device; and a wireless device, configured to communicate with the computer server; wherein the computer server comprises a first computer memory storing computer-executable instructions that, when executed by a first processor of the computer server, causes the computer server to perform steps comprising: authorizing, by a computer server in signal communication with the point-of-sale device, a first financial transaction initiated at the point-of-sale device; posting, by the computer server, the first financial transaction to a source account; calculating, by the computer server, a first savings amount by rounding a transaction amount of the first financial transaction to a nearest whole monetary amount, wherein the first savings amount is a difference between the transaction amount and the nearest whole monetary amount; determining, by the computer server, an aggregate savings amount by adding together the first savings amount and a second savings amount calculated for a second financial transaction posted to the source account; determining, by the computer server, that the aggregate savings amount is available in the source account before debiting the aggregate savings amount from the source account; determining, by the computer server, that the aggregate savings amount has reached a pre-determined threshold; sending, by the computer server, a notification to the wireless device, wherein the wireless device is associated with the source account, that the aggregate

savings amount has reached the pre-determined threshold, wherein the notification includes a signal activating a motor in the wireless device to cause a vibration of the wireless device; receiving, by the computer server from the wireless device, a selective distribution message type, wherein the selective distribution message type comprises selection information, wherein the selection information identifies one or more recipient accounts selected through an interface of the wireless device; and separating then distributing, by the computer server, the selective distribution message type into a plurality of messages to a plurality of banking servers to cause the plurality of banking servers to debit at least a portion of the aggregate savings amount from the source account to the one or more recipient accounts, wherein the separating then distributing of the plurality of messages distributes a processing load among the plurality of banking servers, wherein the separating then distributing of the plurality of messages distributes a processing load among the plurality of banking servers.

12. The system of claim 11, wherein computing load on the point-of-sale device is reduced by deferring calculation of the first savings amount to the computer server, and wherein computing load on the computer server is reduced by postponing a step of debiting at least a portion of the aggregate savings amount from the source account until the aggregate savings amount has reached the pre-determined threshold.

13. A system of claim 11, wherein the wireless device is a tablet.

14. The system of claim 11, wherein the wireless device comprises a second computer memory storing computer-executable instructions that, when executed by a second processor of the wireless device, causes the wireless device to perform steps comprising: presenting the notification that the aggregate savings amount has reached a pre-determined threshold; providing the interface including selectable input elements corresponding to the one or more recipient accounts; receiving the selection information identifying one of the recipient accounts selected at the interface; and transforming the selection information into a selective distribution message type before transmitting the selective distribution message type over a network from the wireless device to the computer server.

15. The system of claim 11, wherein the wireless device receives the selection identifying one of the recipient accounts selected at the interface via voice activation of the wireless device.

16. The system of claim 11, wherein the interface of the wireless device is a touchscreen display.

17. A non-transitory computer-readable storage medium storing computer-executable instructions that, when executed by a computer processor, cause an apparatus to perform steps comprising: authorizing, by a computer server in signal communication with a point-of-sale device, a first financial transaction initiated at the point-of-sale device; posting, by the computer server, the first financial transaction to a source account; calculating, by the computer server, a first savings amount by rounding a transaction amount of the first financial transaction to a nearest whole monetary amount, wherein the first savings amount is a difference between the transaction amount and the nearest whole monetary amount; determining, by the computer server, an aggregate savings amount by adding together the first savings amount and a second savings amount calculated for a second financial transaction posted to the source account; determining, by the computer server, that the aggregate savings amount is available in the source account before debiting the aggregate savings amount from the source account; determining, by the computer server, that the aggregate savings amount has reached a pre-determined threshold; sending, by the computer server, a notification to a mobile device associated with the source account that the aggregate savings amount has reached the pre-determined threshold, wherein the notification comprises a signal activating a motor in the mobile device to cause vibration of the mobile device, and wherein computing load on the point-of-sale device is reduced by deferring calculation of the first savings amount to the computer server, and wherein computing load on the computer server is reduced by postponing a step of debiting at least a portion of the aggregate savings amount from the source account until the aggregate savings amount has reached the pre-determined threshold; receiving, by

the computer server from the mobile device, a selective distribution message type, wherein the selective distribution message type comprises selection information, wherein the selection information identifies one or more recipient accounts selected through an interface of the mobile device; and separating then distributing, by the computer server, the selective distribution message type into a plurality of messages to a plurality of banking servers to cause the plurality of banking servers to debit at least a portion of the aggregate savings amount from the source account to the one or more recipient accounts, wherein the separating then distributing of the plurality of messages distributes a processing load among the plurality of banking servers.

18. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 17 wherein the notification is a selective distribution message type, the selective distribution message type being a unique packet containing fields relating to message identification, source accounts, recipient accounts, savings amounts, dates, and savings selections.

19. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 18 wherein the interface of the mobile device is a graphic display.

20. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 19 wherein the interface is a touchscreen display.
